

Site 161: 15-19/59/1

Zeita

Israel grid: 1550 1991	Soil quality: 6
UTM grid: 6929 5852	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 100 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: about 50
Name type: appears on map as ancient	Water source: Bir Zeita (no. 150), at site
Site type: Arab village on large ruin	Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), 1 km distant
Area: about 30 dunams (3 ha)	Visibility: 4
Topography: low hilltop and slope	Date of visit: Dec. 1987; 60 sherds
Rock type: 'Avdat group	
Soil type: terra rossa	

A medium-sized village on a large ruin, east of Jatt and Kibbutz Magal, on the western slope descending from the Samaria Mountains to the northern Sharon Plain.

The many ancient remains of the ancient site are well preserved. Among them are structures from the Ottoman period built on foundations of large stones. These foundations appear to be ancient (Roman or Byzantine), judging by the building style. In the village are many cisterns, remnants of ancient walls, many rock-cut installations, plundered burial caves (on the southern slope), etc.

The village has a long history. It is mentioned as a Samaritan settlement in the revolt of Babba Rabba (4th century CE). Among its residents was ha-Cohen Levi, one of the elders and rulers of the people (Ben-Zvi 1976: 90). In 1265 it is mentioned as an estate that Sultan Baibars awarded to his warriors after the victory over the Crusaders. In this division, half of the lands of the village and two village quarters were handed over (Abel 1939: 41–42). In the 1596 census there were 91 Moslem taxpayers and nine Christians who paid a tax of 22690 *aqia*. Of this they paid 12420 *aqia* for wheat, 1250 for barley, 3000 for summer crops, 2030 for olives, 400 for various items, 150 for goats and honey and 3440 *jizia* (Hütteroth and 'Abdulfattah 1977: 137).

On 15 March 1799 the village was a frontline outpost of the French army in the battle of Qaqun, which was conducted in its foothills (Gichon 1994: 242–245). In this battle General Lannes' force was drawn into a trap in the valley of 'Attil (the valley of 'Ibthan). From the descriptions of the battle it emerges that the French observed "from the heights of Zeita" the spec-

tacular exercises that the Mamluk horsemen carried out as they avoided the French tactics. In the end the French army had 67 dead and wounded soldiers, while the people of Shechem had about 400; see a more detailed description in the entry on 'Attil (Site 177).

Robinson (1970, II: 302) describes the uprising of the villagers against Egyptian rule in 1834: "In A.D. 1834, on occasion of a levy, the people of the district of Nabulus, like those of Jerusalem and Hebron, rose in rebellion against the Egyptians. The insurrection was so important, that Ibrahim Pasha himself took command of the troops sent to quell it; and encountering a body of the insurgent peasants of Zeita, a village in the north-west part of the province of Nabulus, put them to flight, after killing ninety men. Another large body had posted themselves at Deir, a village on a steep hill not far from Zeita; they were in like manner defeated by storming the hill; and fled, leaving three hundred slain. Ibrahim now retired with his troops to Nabulus, and the whole district submitted without further resistance. Yet the war continued for a still longer time in the region of Hebron".

Guérin (1969b: 346) describes it as follows: "We arrived, after another ascent, at Zeita, a village that sits on a hill and has 600 inhabitants. Like the previous village, here too, I was shown an ancient Corinthian capital, made of white marble, which also had a design of a crater form. Fig and pomegranate orchards are spread out around the village. A handsome well, wide and built of ashlar, was apparently dug in ancient times" [translated from French, A.Z.].

The British Survey, at about that time, describe a: "good-sized village on high ground at the edge of a plain. It is surrounded by fig-gardens, and has olive to the south. It would appear to be an ancient place, having tombs to the east. The supply is principally from wells, but there is a small spring ('Ain esh Shabutbut) on the south-west. The camp was pitched on high ground, south-east of the village, among olives. Two sacred places exist to the south of the village" (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 153).

In 1922 there were 1087 residents, while in 1931 there were 1165 and 237 inhabited houses (Vilnay 1968: 138). In 1944 there were 1780 living in the village while in 1967 the number had dropped to 903 (Brawer 1977: 419).

Pottery: Byzantine – 20%; Early Moslem – 20%; Middle Ages – 30%; Ottoman – 20%; Modern – 10%.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional Bibliography: Dauphin 1998, III: site 157.

Site 162: 15-19/89/1

Khirbet Beit Sama

Israel grid: 1582 1995

UTM grid: 6961 5856

Elevation: 106 m a.s.l., 15 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient and appears on map

Site type: large tell

Area: about 120 dunams (12 ha)

Topography: low hilltop in valley

Rock type: 'Avdat group

Soil type: alluvium

Soil quality: 8

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: about 25

Water sources: Bir Sama (no. 42), and Bir en-Neb'ah, at site

Road: Jatt-Ta'anach (A3), 3.5 km distant

Visibility: 4

Date of visit: Nov., Dec. 1997;

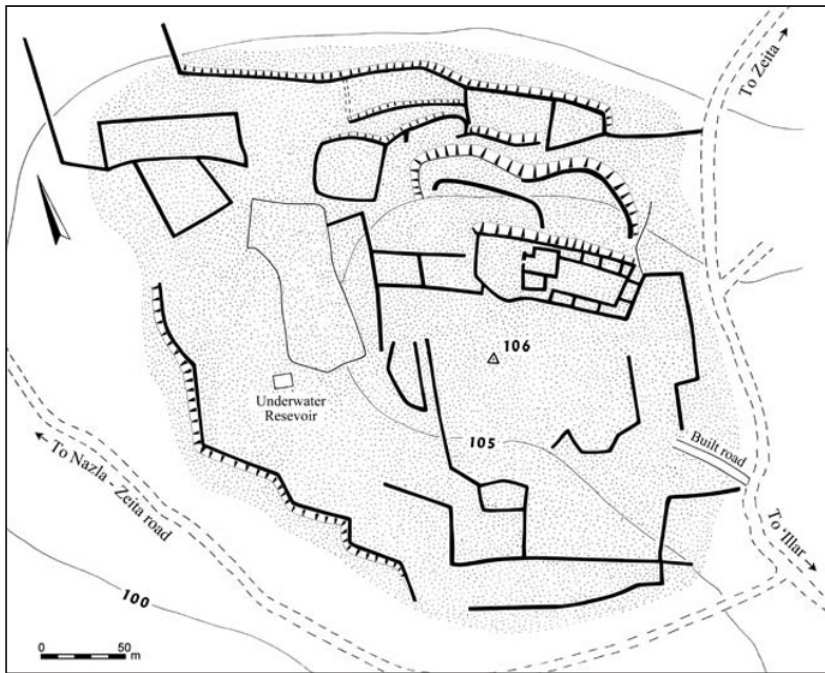
230 sherds

A very large low tell in the eastern part of Zeita Valley, close to the Zeita-'Illar road to the north, and about 3 km east of Zeita. Around the tell are low hill ranges and planted olive trees, and east of it the Şeida-'Illar Range begins to rise. The plains between the ranges are now cultivated and covered with greenhouses.

The tell is surrounded by a low terrace, and is divided into sections or quarters by large supporting walls. In the central and eastern sections there are higher parts, with entire houses *in situ*. Most of them are



196. Bird's-eye view of the large site of Khirbet Beit Sama, looking north, 1998.



197. Plan of Khirbet Beit Sama, 1998.

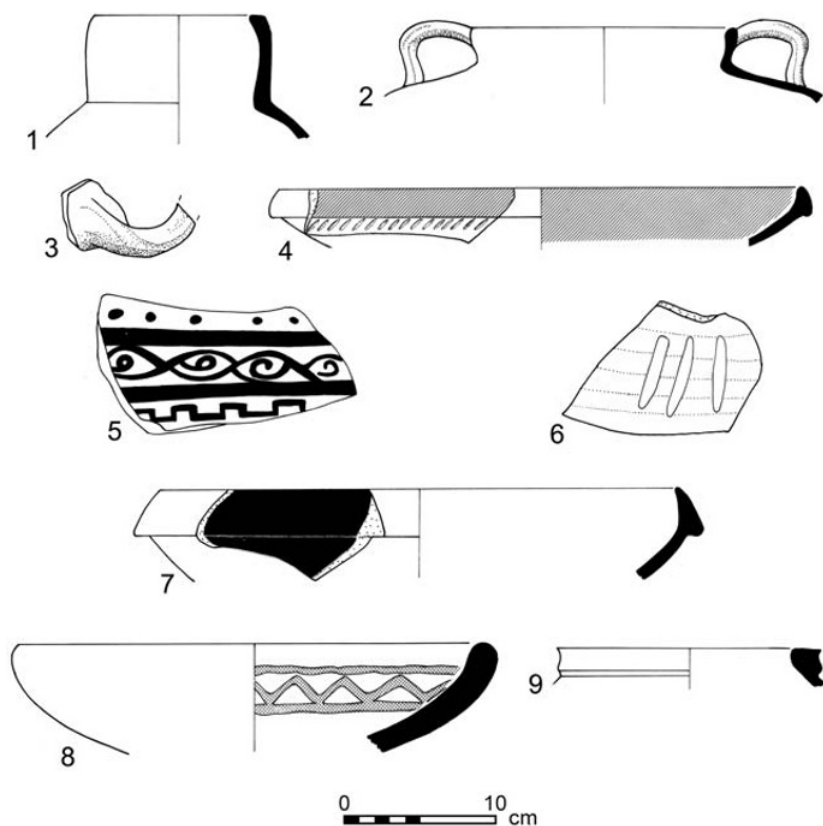
courtyard-houses with elevated structures (towers?). Near the entrance of the north-eastern courtyard is an ornamental stone that was part of the entrance.

On the northern side several terraces were found, the highest of which possibly preserves the ancient fortification from the pre-Byzantine times. On the western side there is a large, shaft-like, underground structure made of stone, about 8×10 m. It seems to be the entrance to the water system. The place is still called Bir es-Sama, and this was probably the water source of the site. On the upper, eastern, section there are several large pits built of stone that appear to be openings to the water system or underground structures. In the east there is a built pathway that leads to the site. Just south-east of the site is another spring known to this day as Bir en-Neb'ah.

The large hill south-west of the site (E.P. 120) served as the cemetery. There are dozens of openings of plundered burial caves, stone covers for graves, and a good deal of ceramics that were removed from the graves, the majority from the Byzantine period. According to the residents, there has been much looting from the graves.

In the British Survey the site itself is not described. It is only recorded: "A tomb is here found blocked up, with an ornamental sculpture over the door in a flat arc of a circle, with two rows apparently of ears of corn in low relief. To the north-west are two ancient watch-towers" (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 196). In the Emergency Survey it is described as: "a ruin on a low hilltop. Its area is about 40 dunams. Remains of many buildings are all over the entire area of the ruin. Construction is of limestone reinforced with clay" (Gophna and Porath 1972: no. 40).

Khirbet Beit Sama was a most important central site in the Zeita Valley. It appears that the tell was founded in an early period (Iron Age?), but



198. Pottery from Khirbet Beit Sama: 1. Jar, gr, Byz; 2. CP, brn, Rom; 3. 'Frying pan' handle, Byz; 4. Bowl, rd slip, LR; 5. Dec, brn on wh, Mam (MA); 6. Dec, wh on blk, Late Byz; 7. Bowl, blk slip, Moslem; 8. Bowl, green glaze on yel, Crusader; 9. Bowl, blk, Byz.

reached its pinnacle as an important city in the Byzantine period. During the Early Moslem period and the Middle Ages, most of the settlement was concentrated on the eastern side. The Byzantine city stretched over an estimated 120 dunams (12 ha), while the Medieval city covered only half of that area.

Local traditions told by the residents impart that this was an important Jewish site, and that in earlier times it was bombarded by catapults (*manjanil* [mangonels]) from Şeida. The historical source of this legend is unclear, and it is not known what event or date is referred to, if any.

Beyer (1936: 38) identifies this site as Bezzemel, a place that appears on the Baibars list of 1265, together with Khirbet ej-Jalameh (Kibbutz Lahavot Haviva of today), 'Attil and Ferasin. According to Röhrich (1887: 257) a place called Bethsama also appears. This is in the area of Tripoli in Syria, and the intention is unclear. It should not be ruled out that Beit Sama may be historic Zeita, but this theory requires proof.

Pottery: Middle Bronze IIb – 5%; Iron I – 5%; Iron II – 5%; Persian – 5%; Hellenistic – 2%; Early Roman – 6%; Late Roman – 10%; Byzantine – 40%; Early Moslem – 10%; Middle Ages – 12%.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972: no. 40.

Additional Bibliography: Dauphin 1998, III: site 155; Salem 2006: site 46.



Site 163: 15-19/99/1

Abu Rish

Israel grid: 1598 1997

UTM grid: 6977 5859

Elevation: 170 m a.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small

Area: 3 dunams (3000 sq. m)

Topography: hilltop

Rock type: 'Avdat group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 8

Cultivation: orchards

Cisterns: 4

Water source: Bir Sama (no. 42),
1.5 km distant

Road: 'Illar-Ra'y (C3), 2 km distant

Visibility: 4

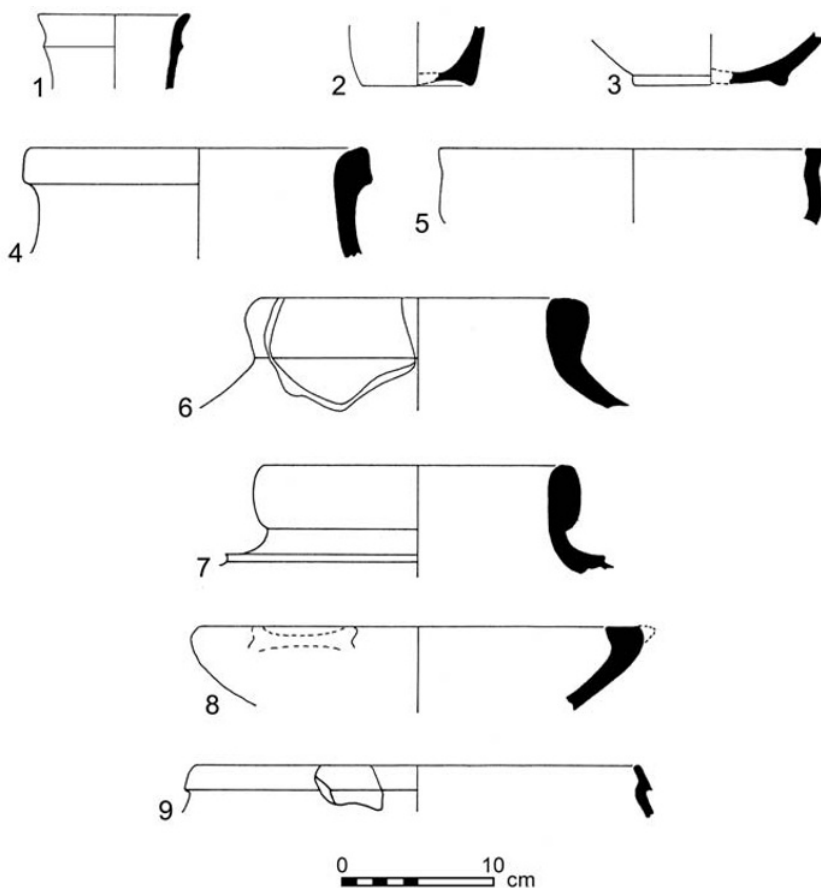
Date of visit: Apr. 1979; 51 sherds

A site on a hilltop at the edge of a long ledge that descends westward from the Şeida block to the valley east of the village of Jatt. This is a good

observation spot over the villages of Jatt, Zeita, Baqa el-Gharbiyeh, and the smaller villages in the region. Two unpaved roads that descend from Şeida pass the site from the north and south.

From the hill, a steep slope descends northward to Wadi el-Bir, while in the south this hill joins the environs. The place itself is in an olive grove, in which a ruined Arab house also stands. On the hilltop are three large stone mounds, certainly composed of the cleared building stones from the site. One of the mounds is elongated, is 4×10 m, and covers a structure. The other mounds are round, each about 5 m in diameter.

The hilltop itself is completely flat, and a few remains of walls (some



199. Pottery from Abu Rish, all IA I: 1.Jug, lt; 2.Jug base, dk; 3.Bowl base, brn; 4.Pithos, dk ; 5.Bowl, lt; 6.Pithos, lt gr; 7.Pithos, dk brn; 8.'Manassite' bowl, gr; 9.CP type B, dk.

integrated into terraces), quarried places, and caves are discernible. On the surface and slopes are sherd scatters, arranged like patches on the ground with spaces between them. It seems that houses once stood here and were dismantled. There are no signs of fortification.

This is a very typical site of an Israelite settlement (Iron Age I), on which a few buildings stood. The ceramics are uniform in colour, and include primarily coarse fragments of pithoi, cooking pots, and a few 'Manassite' bowls.

Pottery: Iron I – 100%.

Previous surveys: None.



Site 164: 16-19/19/1

Tell Wadi el-Bir

Israel grid: 1612 1997

UTM grid: 6991 5859

Elevation: 250 m a.s.l., 40 m b.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: fortified tell

Area: about 100 dunams (10 ha)

Topography: ravine

Rock type: 'Avdat group

Soil type: rendzina and terra rossa

Soil quality: 7

Cultivation: olive groves

Cisterns: none

Water source: Bir es-Siflani (no. 43),
at site

Road: 'I'llar-Ra'y (C3), 1 km distant

Visibility: 2

Date of visit: Jan. 1979, March 1979;

241 sherds

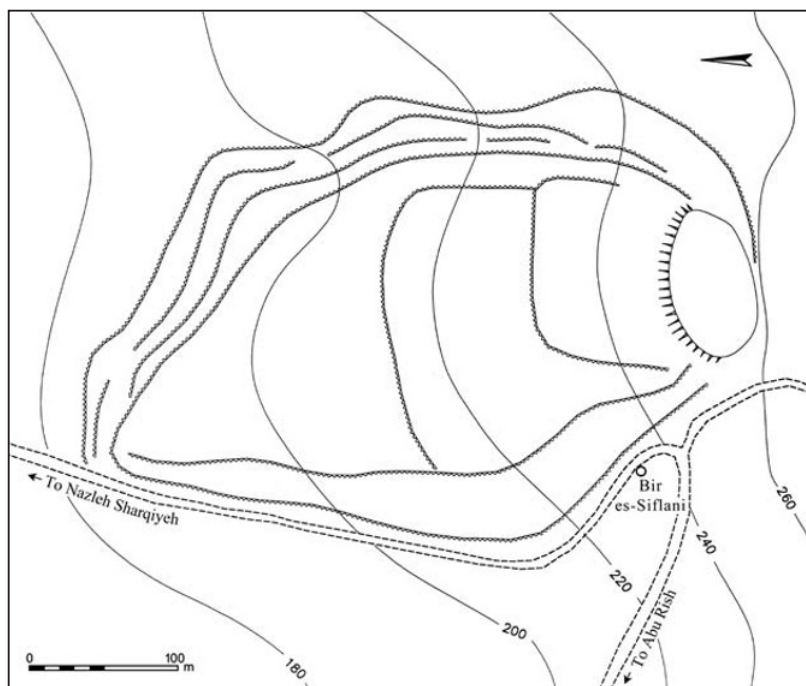
A very large fortified tell in a deep ravine, between Ras Halal in the east and the western edges of Şeida. It is situated on an elongated ridge, surrounded by deep ravines, and descends from south to north, about 700 m north of Şeida. In the western ravine is the water source of the tell, Bir es-Siflani.

On the upper, southern, part of the tell is the elevated fortified 'acropolis', about 8 dunams (8000 sq. m) in area, surrounded by a high thick wall. On it is an especially large pile of stones, about 20 m in diameter. This place was a small settlement in the Persian period.

The large tell is surrounded by a clear line of wall, which has been preserved in several places up to a height of 2–3 m. In the western part of the tell, the wall leans on a low rock cliff. It appears that there were also walls that criss-crossed the site, creating fortified quarters. This can be



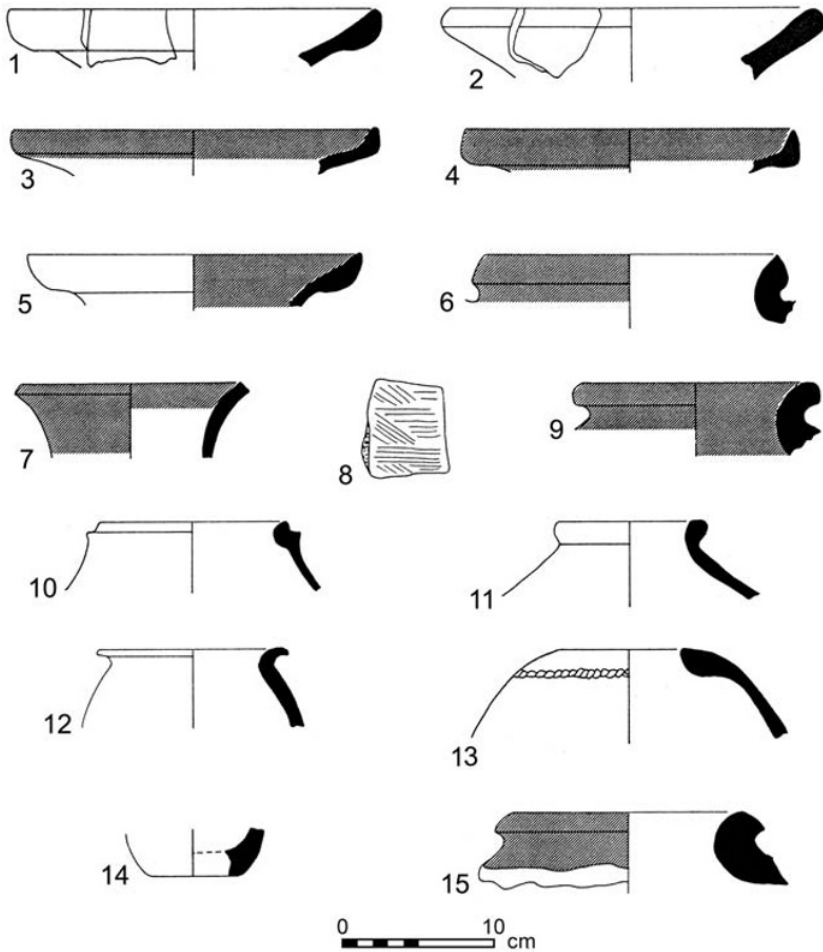
200. Aerial photo of Tell Wadi el-Bir, looking south-east. Note the 'acropolis' in the upper part, from the Persian period. Photo: M. Einav, 1997.



201. Plan of Tell Wadi el-Bir, 1999.

seen in the form of prominent ramparts. Due to many years of cultivation, no structures could be found on the surface, except for a few broken sections of walls. An exceptionally large sherd scatter is found all over the site, along with flint and basalt items.

Tell Wadi el-Bir was a central settlement in western Samaria during the Early Bronze Age, together with the large tells of Nahal Shechem. It is to be



202. Pottery from Tell Wadi el-Bir: 1. Mortaria bowl, yel, Pers; 2. Bowl, yel, Pers; 3-4. Platters, rd on yel, EB; 5. Jar, brn-yel, EB; 6. Jar, rd on yel, EB I; 7. Jar, rd on yel, EB II; 8. Combing patterns, yel, EB II; 9. Jar, rd on yel, EB I-II; 10. CP type D, brn, IA II; 11. Jar, yel, Pers; 12. Jar, brn, EB I; 13. HM, yel, EB I-II; 14. Jug base, yel, EB I-II; 15. Jar, rd on yel, EB I.

noted that this is the only tell of such dimensions in the mountainous part of western Samaria, between Nahal Shechem and Nahal 'Iron.

Pottery: Early Bronze I – 70%; Early Bronze II – 15%; Iron II – 5%; Persian – 10%.

Previous surveys: None.



Site 165: 16-19/19/2

Şeida (on British Survey map: Saida)

Israel grid: 1615 1991

UTM grid: 6994 5852

Elevation: 370 m a.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.

Name type: on map, but not as historic site

Site type: Arab village on large ruin

Area: 15 dunams (1.5 ha)
(ancient core)

Topography: ridge on high mountainous height

Rock type: 'Avdat group

Soil type: rendzina and terra rossa

Soil quality: 7

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: at least 35

Water source: 'Ein Şeida (no. 44),
at site

Road: 'Illar–Ra'y (C3), at site

Visibility: 8

Date of visit: Sept. 1980, 115 sherds

A village on the high western part of the Şeida-Faḥmeh range, overlooking and dominating parts of the Sharon and Narbatah region. The village is now linked by a road westward to 'Illar and eastward by an unpaved road to Kafr Ra'y. In its foothills, in the south, are two springs and the large tell of Wadi el-Bir.

The ancient core of the village is situated on a small tell whose boundaries are indistinct. The slopes of the tell are particularly steep to the north and south. Many building stones are integrated in the houses and fences. Most of the pottery find is on the southern slope.

The village appears as a Crusader estate sold to the Zion Monastery in Jerusalem in 1179, and on the list of estates awarded by Sultan Baibars after the victory over the Crusaders in 1265 (Beyer 1936: 38–39; Abel 1939: 41). In the Ottoman census of 1596 there were 72 Moslem taxpayers there who paid a total of 12160 *aqia* for tax. Of this, 4260 *aqia* were for wheat,

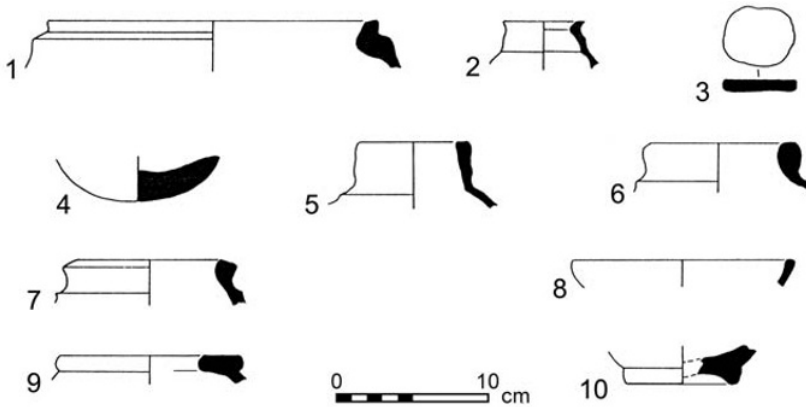
and 1000 for barley, 3000 for olives, 2800 *jizia* and more for miscellaneous (Hütteroth and 'Abdufattah 1977: 130).

The British Survey team describes it as: "A small village, with a well on the east on the back of a long and bare ridge. It has a few trees to the east" (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 155).

In 1931 there were 351 residents and 75 inhabited houses (Vilnay 1968: 339). Grossman (1986: 345) believes (with no documentation) that the village may have been abandoned at the end of the 18th or beginning of the 19th century CE.

Pottery: Iron II – 35%; Hellenistic – 15%; Early Roman – 15%; Late Roman – 10%; Byzantine – 15%; Early Moslem – 5%; Middle Ages – 5%.

Previous surveys: None.



203. Pottery from Şeida: 1.CP, brn, IA II; 2.Jar, dk, ER; 3.Clay stopper, IA II; 4.Jar base, dk brn, IA II; 5.Jar, blk, LR; 6.Jar, brn, IA II; 7.Jar, gr, IA II; 8.Bowl, lt brn, LR; 9.HM, gr, IA II; 10.Jug base, brn, IA II.

Site 166: 16-19/19/3

Ez-Z'aureh

Israel grid: 1618 1998

UTM grid: 6997 5861

Elevation: 320 m a.s.l., 70 m a.s.a.

Name type: local

Site type: medium-sized

Area: about 5 dunams (5000 sq. m)

Topography: moderate slope

Rock type: 'Avdat group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 7

Cultivation: olive orchard

Cisterns: about 10

Water source: Bir es-Siflani (no. 43),
800 m distant

Road: 'Illar-Ra'y (C3), 500 m distant

Visibility: 7

Date of visit: July 1998, 47 sherds

A site on the northern slope of the Ras Halal Range, about 800 m north of Şeida, overlooking Tel Wadi el-Bir. A new unpaved road passes by the site, going from Nazleh esh-Sharqiyeh to Şeida.

The houses of the site were dismantled in order to prepare the land for planting olive orchards, and their stones were integrated in the fences made of cleared stones. On the site's surface only a sherd scatter remains, with mosaic stones, glass fragments, and a few building stones. There are also many quarried places: installations, winepresses, burial caves, etc.

Pottery: Late Roman – 20%; Byzantine – 80%.

Previous surveys: None.

Site 167: 16-19/59/1

Wadi Ḥardan

Israel grid: 1657 1998

UTM grid: 7036 5861

Elevation: 360 m a.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small, fortified ruin

Area: 2 dunams (2000 sq. m)

Topography: edge of ridge

Rock type: Mount Scopus group

Soil type: rendzina and brown forest

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: 1

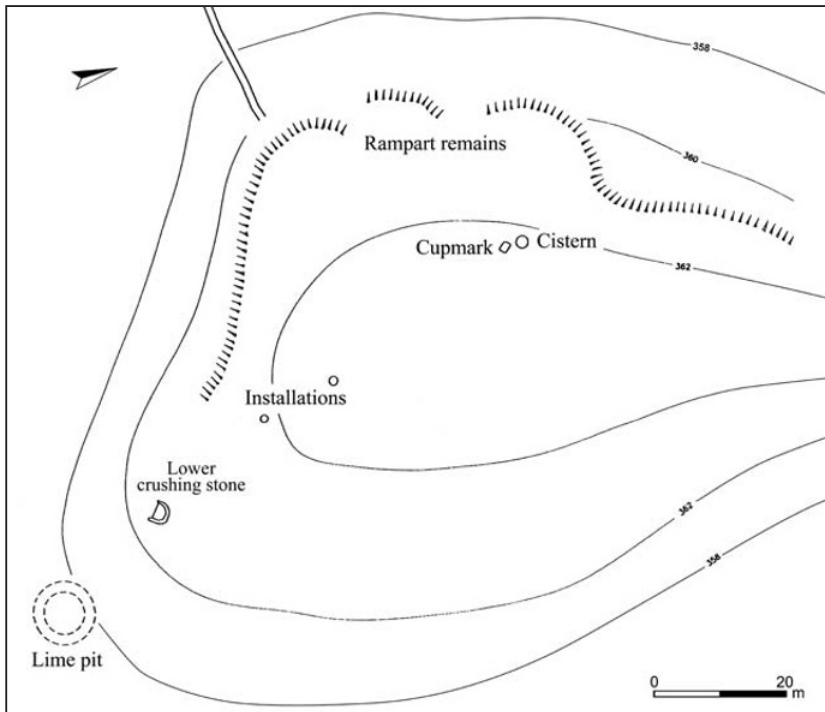
Water source: Bir Shafūr [‘Einot
Faḥmeh] (no. 45), 1.2 km distant

Road: Yemmeh–Zawiyah (C2),
500 m distant

Visibility: 3

Date of visit: Mar. 1979, plan: Sept.
1997; 40 sherds

A small site on a flat hilltop at the edge of a ridge, in the chalky rock area west of the high tell of Baṭn Umm Nari. Just west of it is an unpaved road



204. Plan of the fortified Middle Bronze Age enclosure at Wadi Ḥardan, 1998.

leading from Kafr Ra'y to Şeida.

The site is fortified by a rampart built of stones and earth, surrounding the eastern and southern sides of the site in a semicircle. Within the rampart area there are remains of walls about 2 m thick, which could not be assembled into a clear plan. They possibly belonged to dwelling places or to the rampart, whose function was to serve as fortification for the site. The difference in masonry between these walls and the agricultural terraces in the area suggests that the walls are settlement remains. Near the walls are quarried places and cupmarks. A homogeneous single-period sherd scatter is dispersed over the entire surface of the site.

Worthy of note is the similarity of Wadi Ḥardan and the sites of Abu Mizr in the Sebastiyeh region (Zertal 2004: site 196), el-Muraba'ah in the Qabatiyeh plains (Zertal 2004: site 54), and Hariqet er-Ras in the fringes of the Jezreel Valley (Site 55 in this volume). These four sites comprise a particular type of village fortified by ramparts of Middle Bronze Age II; they are worthy of further study.

Pottery: Middle Bronze IIb – 100%.

Previous surveys: Zertal 1984: no 58.

Additional Bibliography: Salem 2006: site 93.



Site 168: 16-19/59/2

Kashkul

Israel grid: 1653 1994

UTM grid: 7032 5857

Elevation: 412 m a.s.l., 45 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: structure and small site

Area: 1.5 dunams (1500 sq. m)

Topography: hilltop on
mountainous height

Rock type: Mount Scopus group

Soil type: rendzina and brown forest

Soil quality: 7

Cultivation: orchards and field
crops

Cisterns: 4

Water source: Bir Safa (no. 46),
1.6 km distant

Road: 'Illar–Ra'y (C3), 800 m distant

Visibility: 4

Date of visit: Apr. 1978; 39 sherds

A small ruin on a high hilltop, south of Wadi Sultan and near the watershed point of Kafr Ra'y and Faḥmeh. From the ruin there is good observation

over Daharet Khais, Barquneh and Baṭn Umm Nari.

The hilltop is isolated by steep slopes descending from it to the east, north and west. A saddle provides access in the south to Baṭn Qis Range. Today a modern structure stands there. Next to it ancient walls were found, with masonry of large, chiselled stones, five burial caves with openings cut in the form of arches, and several rock-cut installations. In the northern part a broken section of a limestone column was found.

Pottery: Byzantine – 60%; Early Moslem – 20%; Middle Ages – 20%.

Previous surveys: Zertal 1984: no. 59.



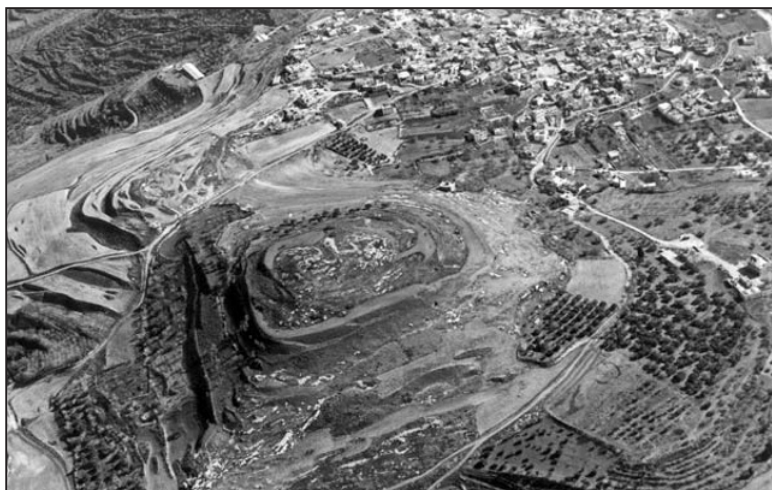
Site 169: 16-19/69/1

Baṭn Umm Nari (on British Survey map: Batn en-Nari)

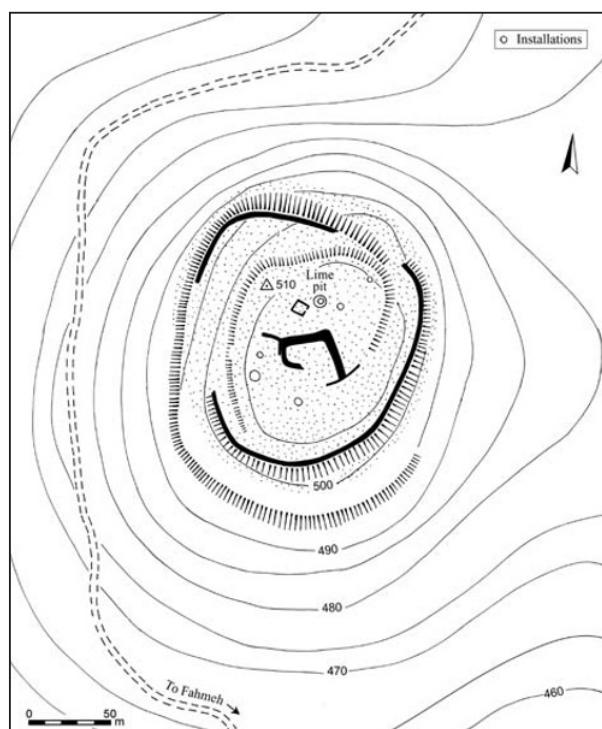
Israel grid: 1668 1992	Cultivation: none
UTM grid: 7048 5855	Cisterns: 1
Elevation: 510 m a.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.	Water source: Bir Shafur [‘Einot
Name type: ancient, but not on map	Faḥmeh] (no. 45), 300 m distant
Site type: fortified tell	Road: Yemmeh–Zawiyah (C2),
Area: 35 dunams (3500 sq. m)	500 m distant
Topography: high summit	Visibility: 9
Rock type: Mount Scopus group	Date of visits: Apr. 1978, and many
Soil type: rendzina and brown forest	others; 92 sherds
Soil quality: 4	

A fortified tell at the top of a high summit, close to the village of Faḥmeh and at the watershed point of Faḥmeh and Kafr Ra’y. The road from ‘Arrabeh to Ra’y passes south of the site. There is an extensive view into the Dothan Valley, with the hilly area south of it, the Sanur Valley and the regions around it.

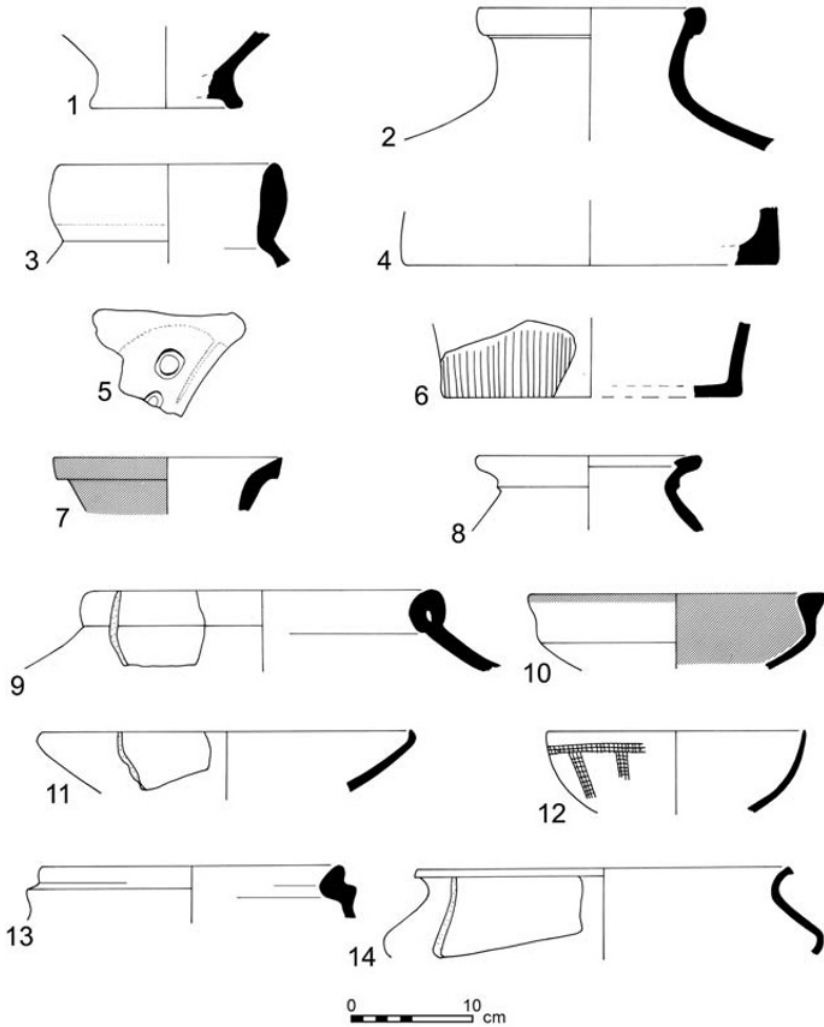
To the north, south and west of the tell are steep slopes, and it is connected in the east (Šal’ah Range) via a narrow saddle. The tell descends from the hilltop in a series of very steep terraces. The highest of these, about 5 m, appears to be a city wall built of medium-sized stones. Most of this wall is now covered by an earthen rampart, and it is composed of non-contiguous sections. It may be surmised that the wall was built during the Early Bronze Age, and the rampart in the Middle Bronze Age. The



205. Aerial photo of Batn Umm-Nari, looking south. Photo: M. Weinberg, 1998. Beyond the tell the village of Faḥmeh can be seen.



206. Plan of Batn Umm-Nari, 1998.



207. Pottery from Baṭn Umm-Nari: 1. Jug base, brn, IA I; 2. Pithos-jar, yel, MB II; 3. Pithos, gr, IA I; 4. Jar base, EB I-II; 5. Mat impressions on jar handle, brn, IA I; 6. Jar base with combing designs, gr, EB II; 7. Jar, rd on yel, EB I-II; 8. Jar, yel, MB II; 9. Folded krater, dk, MB II; 10. Bowl, rd on brn, IA II-III; 11. Bowl, yel, MB II; 12. "Milk bowl", brn on beige, LB II; 13. CP, brn, IA II; 14. CP A, brn, LB-IA I.

approach seems to be from the east, where there is a clear break in the wall.

At the summit is a large mound of stones (including building stones) and exposed rock surfaces. On these surfaces are various types of quarried places and a cistern. On the western part are traces of buildings made of drafted stones, as well as thick walls made of cleared stones. The tell obtained its water from two active springs in the area (Bir es-Safa and Bir Shafur).

Apparently the tell already had its present form in the Early Bronze Age. The settlement remained large and important in the Middle and Late Bronze Ages. In the Late Bronze Age there was a small fortified settlement, while in Iron Age I it was medium-sized.

The location of the site is linked with the water sources around it, and also, perhaps, with the ancient road from the Sharon Plain to the heart of the mountain on the 'Illar–Faḥmeh axis (route of road C2).

Pottery: Early Bronze I – 25%; Early Bronze II – 10%; Middle Bronze IIB – 25%; Late Bronze – 15%; Iron I – 20%; Iron II – 5%.

Identification: It is suggested that this is Nuribda of the el-Amarna letters; see Chapter 2.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972: no 41; Zertal 1984: no. 60.

Additional Bibliography: Goren et al. 2004: 352; Salem 2006: site 43.



Site 170: 16-19/78/1

Faḥmeh

Israel grid: 1672 1988

UTM grid: 7051 5851

Elevation: 455 m a.s.l., 25 m a.s.a.

Name type: on map, but not as ancient

Site type: Arab village on ruin

Area: 15 dunams (1.5 ha)
(ruin alone)

Topography: hilltop on mountainous height

Rock type: Mount Scopus group

Soil type: rendzina and brown forest

Soil quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 35

Water source: Bir Safa (no. 46),
at site

Road: Yemmeh–Zawiyah (C2),
at site

Visibility: 8

Date of visits: Apr. 1978, many visits;
80 sherds

A village on a high chalky slope in the hill range of 'Arrabeh-Ra'y, slightly south of Baṭn Umm Nari. South of it passes the road from Kafr Ra'y to 'Arrabeh. From the site is a fine view of the valleys of er-Rameh and Dothan. There are four springs nearby.

In the ancient core of the village, there are many building stones, traces of walls and many quarried places. The character of the ancient ruin has been almost entirely erased by new construction.

On the saddle to the west of the village is a double-domed structure, built on Medieval foundations: the tomb of Sheikh Kasab. The tomb may stand on the foundations of a Crusader church, which may in turn stand upon the foundations of a synagogue. In this area there is a carved stone door, published by Avi-Yonah, apparently belonging to the Samaritan or Jewish synagogue; see below.

During the Middle Ages Faḥmeh is mentioned by 'Abd el-Ghani (1105 CE), as being on the route of his pilgrimage. During the Crusader times it is mentioned as the estate of the Mount Zion Monastery, which received half the tithe of the two villages (Beyer 1940: 184–185, 195, 201).

In the Mamluk period it is mentioned as a station on the express road for bringing snow from Damascus to Cairo, between Jenin and Qaqun (Volney 1798–1799: 33) and also as a high station for conveying messages with beacons and a station for mounted postmen (Volney 1798–1799: 38). In the Ottoman census of 1596 the village (which was in the Jabel Shami province) had 21 Moslem taxpayers who paid tax of 6000 *aqia*. Of this 2130 was paid for wheat and 500 for barley, 866 for summer crops, 1500 for olives (750 Islamic olive trees or 1500 Roman olive trees), 300 for goats and honey, 12 for olive presses and 450 for *jizia* (Hütteroth and 'Abdulfattah 1977: 130). The British Survey found: "A small mud hamlet on a saddle beneath the hill (Batnen Nury). It has a well and a fig-garden towards the north" (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 154).

The site is not mentioned by Guérin. In 1931 there were 238 residents and 38 inhabited homes (Vilnay 1968: 333).

The stone door mentioned above served as flooring near the entrance to the mosque. It was photographed in 1946 by Mahuli and published by Avi-Yonah (1947). On the stone relief are images of two closed doors, each of them divided into five recessed surfaces: two large squares with small squares in the centre, and three recessed rectangles above and below the squares. Each door has a column next to it, and above the doors and columns is a large shell.

Avi-Yonah, who dated the find to the 3rd–4th century CE, views the relief

as “the image of the Holy Ark in its typical form”. Nearby a carved lintel was also found. Mazar (1973: 176-177) accepts this view, and finds substantiation for it in Beit She’arim. Safrai (1977: 101, 104) suggests that this was a Samaritan synagogue. According to Grossberg (1991) it should be seen as a description of the façade of the Temple, and thus was a Jewish synagogue.

Pottery: Early Roman – 10%; Late Roman – 20%; Byzantine – 30%; Early Moslem – 10%; Middle Ages – 10%; Ottoman – 10%; Modern – 10%.

Previous surveys: Zertal 1984: no. 65.



208. Baṭn Umm Nari (the tell at left) and the village of Faḥmeh (at right), looking eastward, 1978. Photo: A. Zertal.



209. Carved stone door found at Faḥmeh (Avi-Yonah 1947: fig. 3:1).

Site 171: 16-19/79/1

Es-Şal'ah

Israel grid: 1671 1993	Soil quality: 4
UTM grid: 7050 5856	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 480 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name type: nearest place	Water source: Bir Shafir ['Einot
Site type: small	Faḥmeh] (no. 45), 300 m distant
Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)	Road: Yemmeh–Zawiyah (C2),
Topography: hilltop on	800 m distant
mountainous height	Visibility: 8
Rock type: Mount Scopus group	Date of visit: Apr. 1978; 29 sherds
Soil type: rendzina and brown forest	

A site on a high, narrow ridge, slightly north of the village of Faḥmeh, and east of the tell of Baṭn Umm Nari, in the region of the high range between Ra'y and Faḥmeh. There is an especially good view of both the Dothan Valley and the er-Rammeh Valley.

On a narrow ridge, oriented approximately north-south, is a sherd scatter on several built cultivation terraces. No building traces were found, but apparently the structures were dismantled so that the land could be cultivated. It may be surmised that this was a subsidiary settlement of the large site at Baṭn Umm Nari, nearby, and that several buildings once stood here.

Pottery: Iron I – 10%; Iron II – 20%; Persian – 70%.

Previous surveys: Zertal 1984: no. 61.

Additional Bibliography: Salem 2006: site 289.

Site 172: 16-19/99/1

Khirbet Dar Abu Şelah

Israel grid: 1698 1999	Soil quality: 6
UTM grid: 7076 5863	Cultivation: orchards
Elevation: 392 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: 3
Name type: ancient, but not on map	Water source: Bir Shafur ['Einot
Site type: structure and small site	Fahmeh] (no. 45), 2 km distant
Area: 2.7 dunams (2700 sq. m)	Road: Sharaf-Jenin (B4), 1.5 km
Topography: hilltop on	distant
mountainous height	Visibility: 5
Rock type: Mount Scopus group	Date of visit: Nov. 1978; 51 sherds
Soil type: terra rossa	

A small ruin on a hilltop in the hilly area south of 'Arrabeh, north-east of Fahmeh. From the site is a view of Wadi D'auch and the road from the Dothan Valley to Sebastiyeh.

At the site are traces of a structure 7×8.5 m, built of large, drafted stones. Remains of walls and building stones are visible, used in terraces made of cleared stones. On the east side of the structure is a threshold stone. It seems that the place served as an agricultural farmstead.

Pottery: Byzantine – 100%.

Previous surveys: Zertal 1984: no. 62.



Site 173: 15-19/48/1

Jebel Bir Zeita

Israel grid: 1544 1985	Soil quality: 7
UTM grid: 6923 5846	Cultivation: field crops
Elevation: 68 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name type: nearest place	Water source: Bir Zeita (no. 150),
Site type: sherd scatters	400 m distant
Area: 0.5 dunam (500 sq. m)	Road: Jatt-Megiddo (A1), 400 m
Topography: valley fringe	distant
Rock type: alluvium cover	Visibility: 2
Soil type: alluvium	Date of visit: Dec. 1987; 26 sherds

A small site and sherd scatter on the western fringes of Sahel 'Ibthan, about 400 m south-west of the village of Zeita.

Sherd scatters were found, without any obvious architectural elements, in the field that descends moderately to the centre of Sahel 'Ibthan. North of the site is a ravine that ascends on the range in the direction of Zeita. Apparently several houses stood here during the Early Bronze Age I. This is a well-known phenomenon of that period.

Pottery: Early Bronze I – 100%.

Previous surveys: None.



Site 174: 15-19/38/1

Khirbet Rujjum

Israel grid: 1538 1982

UTM grid: 6917 5842

Elevation: 65 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient, but not on map

Site type: tell

Area: 12 dunams (1.2 ha)

Topography: centre of valley

Rock type: 'Avdat group

Soil type: rendzina and alluvium

Soil quality: 8

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: 1

Water source: Bir es-Sikkeh (no. 54),
at site

Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), at site

Visibility: 2

Date of visit: Dec. 1987; 64 sherds

A large site on a low hill in the middle of Sahel 'Ibthan, one of the small valleys that connect northern Samaria with the Sharon Plain. The road from the 'Iron Junction to Tulkarm crosses the centre of the site. South of the hill of the site is the shallow channel of Wadi Massin. The ruin is located about 1 km south of Kibbutz Magal.

Just west of the road, in the western part of the ancient site, is a concentration of large building stones spread over an area of about 2 dunams (2000 sq. m), the result of clearing the land for cultivation. In the other parts of the hill and in the area around it is a sherd scatter without any structural remains. Judging by the sherd scatter, this was a large site that stood in the centre of the valley.

A salvage excavation was carried out at the site in 1994 (Shalem 1996).

Remains of Early Bronze Age I sherds, an un-walled settlement from the Middle Bronze Age II, and pits from the Persian period were uncovered.

In 1998 another excavation was conducted (Lerer 2008; Israel grid 1537/1982). Two layers were exposed: a structure dated to the Middle Bronze Age IIa period and walls from the Persian period.

Pottery (Summary of the different surveys and excavations): Early Bronze I-II; Middle Bronze IIb; Persian; Hellenistic.

Identification: This is one of the candidates for *h-b-d-n* from the Egyptian sources; see Chapter 2.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972: no. 47.



Site 175: 16-19/78/2

Baṭn el-Hawa

Israel grid: 1676 1984

UTM grid: 7055 5848

Elevation: 453 m a.s.l., 35 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: sherd scatters

Area: 2 dunams (2000 sq. m)

Topography: hilltop

Rock type: Mount Scopus group

Soil type: rendzina and brown forest

Soil quality: 4

Cultivation: groves and field crops

Cisterns: none

Water source: Bir Safa (no. 46),
1 km distant

Road: Yemmeh–Zawiyah (C2),
1 km distant

Visibility: 7

Date of visit: Apr. 1978; 31 sherds

A site on a high hilltop, south of Faḥmeh, and just south of the Faḥmeh–'Arrabeh road. From the site there is a view of er-Rammeh Valley.

No structural remains were found, but agricultural installations on exposed rock surfaces. On the hilltop, and especially on the northern slope, were sherd scatters, possibly connected to activities of the agricultural installations. There may also have been a small settlement here.

Pottery: Early Roman – 20%; Late Roman – 30%; Byzantine – 20%; Early Moslem – 15%; Middle Ages – 15%.

Previous surveys: Zertal 1984: no. 66.

Site 176: 16-19/88/1

Baṭn eṭ-Ṭay

Israel grid: 1683 1985	Soil quality: 6
UTM grid: 7062 5848	Cultivation: groves
Elevation: 453 m a.s.l., 45 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name type: nearest place	Water source: Bir Safa (no. 46), 1.5 km distant
Site type: small ruin	Road: Yemmeh–Zawiyah (C2), 1 km distant
Area: 3 dunams (3000 sq. m)	Visibility: 7
Topography: hilltop	Date of visit: Apr. 1978; 39 sherds
Rock type: Mount Scopus group	
Soil type: rendzina and brown forest	

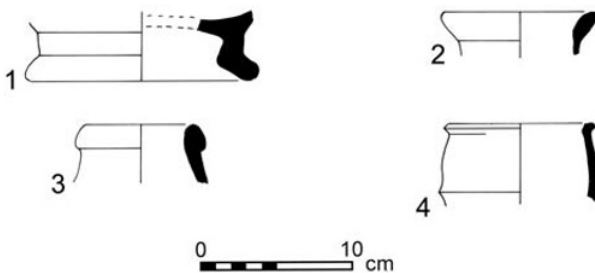
A small site on a high hilltop south-east of Faḥmeh. Terraced steep slopes descend from the hilltop to the north, east, and south. To the west, the hill is connected by a narrow saddle to Baṭn el-Hawa. There is a good view of the hilly area south of Faḥmeh.

On the summit is a large mound of stones, 4 m high and about 8 m in diameter, without any adjacent structures. Around it are many places where the exposed rock is quarried, and many building stones are integrated in the fences of cleared stones. Presumably there were several buildings here, whose stones were collected into the mound.

About 300 m south-east of the hilltop, on the saddle sloping down from the ridge, are rock surfaces with sherds.

Pottery: Iron II – 5%; Persian-Hellenistic – 15%; Early Roman – 10%; Late Roman – 35%; Byzantine – 35%.

Previous surveys: Zertal 1984: no. 67.



210. Pottery from Baṭn eṭ-Ṭay: 1. Mortaria base, yel, Pers; 2. Jar, lt, Hel; 3. Jar, gr, Pers; 4. Jar, lt brn, ER.

Site 177: 15-19/77/1

'Attil

Israel grid: 1570 1973	forest
UTM grid: 6950 5834	Soil quality: 7
Elevation: 110 m a.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.	Cultivation: none
Name type: appears on map as ancient	Cisterns: 60
Site type: village on tell	Water source: Bir Sama (no. 42), 2.5 km distant
Area: 50 dunams (5 ha) (core and environs)	Road: Yemmeh-Zawiyah (C2), at site
Topography: hilltop on valley fringe	Visibility: 4
Rock type: 'Avdat group	Date of visit: Dec. 1982; 40 sherds
Soil type: terra rossa and brown	

An Arab village on a large tell on the north bank of Wadi Massin, at the eastern opening of a small internal valley (Sahel 'Ibthan) which runs eastward from the Sharon Plain.

The village comprises a road junction and an important settlement. Its large ancient core, extending over the tell whose slopes have been defaced due to intensive construction work, is slightly south of the village centre. Parts of an earthen rampart are discernible. This was the original boundary of the tell, which appears to have been founded in Middle Bronze Age II. Both on the tell itself, which is slightly elevated above the modern village, and around it, many remains are still visible *in situ*. Among these are many walls of drafted stones and field stones, and parts of installations: rock-cut basins, parts of an oil press, decorated lintels, and many quarried caves and cisterns.

Most of the ancient pottery (from Middle Bronze Age II to the Persian period) was found on the southern slopes of the tell, descending to Wadi Massin.

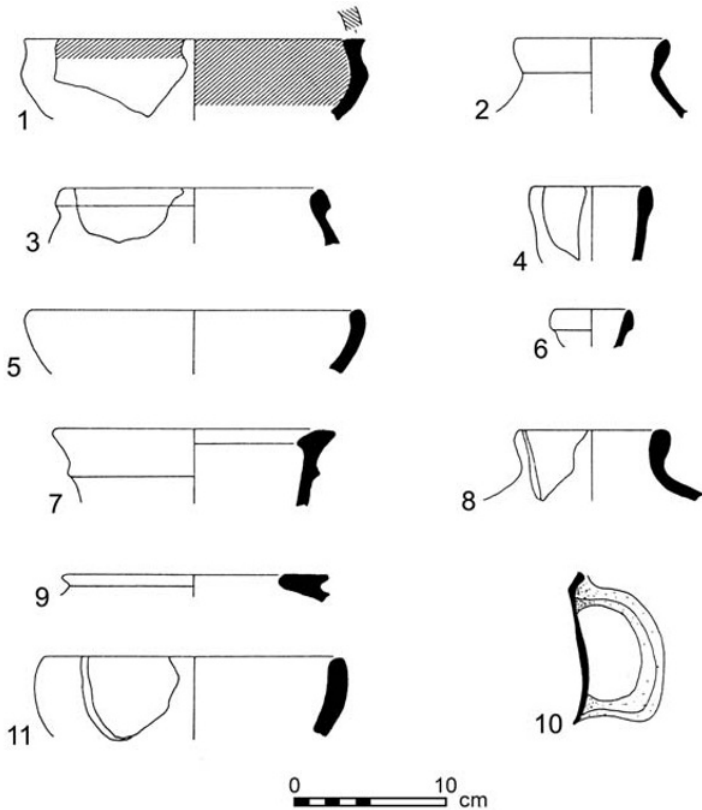
In the village itself are the tombs of Sheikh Maklad and Sheikh Sa'ad ed-Din. On a hill south-east of the village is the built tomb of Sheikh Nabhan, and around it some Medieval sherds.

The village was apparently mentioned during the Crusader period. In 1179, Walter, the Vizegrav of Tiberias, announced that he had purchased Casalien Azatil for 1000 byzants for the Hospitallers. Röhrich (1887: 245) bases his identification of this estate with the village of 'Attil on the fact that the estate of Azatil is situated in the Caesarea region. In 1200 it

appears in the form of Hatil on a list of Crusader estates (Beyer 1936: 38, 47). In March 1265, when Sultan Baibars awarded his officers lands from the Crusaders' booty, the village was given: "To the Atabek Faris al-Din Uqtay al-Salihi, 'Attil in its entirety" (Lyons 1971: 80).

In the 1596 census 59 Moslem taxpayers living there paid a total annual tax of 14872 *aqia*, of which 5680 were for wheat, 1250 for barley, 1500 for summer crops, 3500 for olive trees, and 2360 for *jizia* (Hütteroth and 'Abdulfattah 1977: 126).

On 15 March 1799 an important battle took place at the approach to 'Attil, between the armies of Napoleon Bonaparte, which was advancing north toward Acco (Acre), and 1500-2000 Mamluk cavalry joined by 4000



211. Pottery from 'Attil: 1 'Samaritan' bowl, rd slip on lt, IA II; 2.Jar, yel, Pers-Hel; 3, 5.Bowls, brn, IA I; 4, 6.Jugs, brn, Rom; 7.Jar, lt, MB II; 8.Jar, gr, Pers; 9.HM, yel, IA II; 10.'Frying pan', handle, brn, Byz; 11.'Manasseh' bowl, dk, IA I.

men from the Shechem area (Gichon 1994: 242–245). The Mamluk cavalry were arrayed on the right flank, and the men of Shechem on the left, both next to Zeita. The French general, Lannes, was drawn by the Shechem warriors into a trap in the ‘Attil Valley (‘Ibthan Valley) between ‘Attil and Deir el-Ghuṣun. The battle ended in retreat by the French forces, with 67 casualties on the French side and about 400 casualties among the men from Shechem. The French described, from their vantage point in the heights of Zeita, the “colourful rows of Mamluk cavalry, with their flags and banners, galloping northward”. Napoleon berated Lannes severely for the complications in the Battle of ‘Attil. Lannes sought to excuse his behaviour, saying that the people of the mountain had provoked him and he wanted to teach them a lesson. He told Napoleon that it was the mountain that defeated him.

Robinson (1970, III: 124) visited here on 22 Apr. 1852 and described: “At 10 o’clock we left the Ramleh road, which proceeds by way of Zeita, and turned directly south towards ‘Attil. We were now nearly or quite down the mountain; and almost on a level with the great plain. The region round about us was an open rocky tract or basin, with low rounded naked hills, shut in from the western plain by the low broad rocky ridges in front, on which the villages of Jatt and Zeita are situated; the former on a marked Tell. All the valleys and outlets which run to the great plain, have very little descent. We crossed a fine level basin in order to reach ‘Attil; the soil was stony, but strong. We came at 10.40 to that village, situated on a hill with plains on the north and south. It is a considerable village; and in the street we noticed a large fragment of double column. A horseman from Zeita had overtaken us, and kept us company until our roads parted. He was very civil, and gave us a good deal of information. It appears, that the land in the district of Nablus including the plains, is generally freehold; and the taxes are mainly paid in the form of a poll tax”.

The British Survey described “A considerable village, on a hill at the edge of the plain, with open ground to the north and a broad valley to the south. It has round it a small olive-grove, and is supplied by cisterns.” (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 151).

Guérin (1969b: 345) wrote: “we rode straight south on a very fertile plain. On my left, a few kilometres east, I was shown the village of Deir Attil. It sits on a high hill” [translated from French, A.Z.].

In 1922 there were 1656 residents. In 1931 there were 2207 residents and 473 inhabited houses (Vilnay 1968: 330). Grossman (1986: 345) suggests various origins for the inhabitants: from Khan Yunis, Egypt and Lebanon.

The large tell of 'Attil, which was unknown until now, has been inhabited almost continuously from the Middle Bronze Age on, and was apparently an important tell in the region.

The source of the name is almost certainly in the Hebrew form *a-tl*, *tll*, appearing in the Bible as a prefix to place names (e.g., Ezekiel 3: 15; Ezra 2: 59, etc.) and also, especially, in the Samaria ostraca in the form of *tll* (sherd no. 21), *ha-tl* (sherd no. 56) and *krm ha tl* (sherds 53, 54, 61 and 3892, 3893) (Lemaire 1977).

Pottery (in and around 'Attil): Middle Bronze II – 10%; Iron I – 10%; Iron II – 5%; Persian – 5%; Hellenistic – 5%; Early Roman – 5%; Late Roman – 10%; Byzantine – 10%; Early Moslem – 10%; Middle Ages – 10%; Ottoman – 10%; Modern – 10%.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional Bibliography: Beyer 1940: 186; Brawer 1977: 419; Dauphin 1998, III: site 165.



Site 178: 16-19/07/1

'Illar (on British Survey map: 'Ellar)

Israel grid: 1604 1974

UTM grid: 6983 5836

Elevation: 235 m a.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.

Name type: appears on map as Arab village

Site type: village on tell

Area: 4 dunams (4000 sq. m)
(ancient core)

Topography: hilltop on
mountainous height

Rock type: Mount Scopus group

Soil type: rendzina and terra rossa

Soil quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: about 40

Water source: Bir es-Siflani (no. 43),
2.2 km distant

Road: 'Illar–Ra'y (C3), at site

Visibility: 4

Date of visit: Dec. 1982; 40 sherds

A medium-sized village at the edge of a high ridge, descending from the Şeida range to the west, and to Wadi Massin to the south. The road from Zeita to 'Illar rises up the ridge, apparently following the route of an ancient path. From the village there is a good view of the hills to the east toward Kafr Ra'y.

In the middle of the village is a small ancient core of a fortified tell, in the

central and eastern parts of the high hilltop. The core includes a mosque, next to which is the tomb of Sheikh Muhammad Nuban, and a fortified architectural complex. This complex includes at least two building stages: foundations of large stones (perhaps from the Roman-Byzantine periods) and upon them, walls of medium-sized stones (Medieval and Ottoman). Within the core are plundered burial caves, many quarried places and cisterns.

South of the tell's hilltop, there is another hilltop on which there are ancient structural remains among modern houses. Here caves and many quarried places are found. All the ancient sherds (Iron Age II), were scattered on the slopes of this hilltop.

The place is mentioned in the year 1200 as Allar (Beyer 1936: 38), and also in the list of estates granted by Sultan Baibars to his warriors in 1265 after the victory over the Crusaders (Abel 1939: 41).

In the Ottoman census of 1596 the village was in the *Liwa* (district) of Nablus and in the Jabal Shami province. There were 41 Moslem taxpayers living there paying 5074 *aqia* as its annual tax, of which 710 were for wheat, 250 for barley, 500 for summer crops, 1500 for olives, 200 for miscellaneous, 290 for goats and honeybees and 1640 for *jizia*. The olives alone accounted for 29% of the village's income (Hütteroth and 'Abdulfattah 1977: 126).

The British Survey describes: "A small village on the side of a hill, with olives and wells. The name suggests its identity with Aner, a Levitical city of Manasseh (I Chron. vi. 70)" (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 154).

In 1931 there were 1047 residents and 268 inhabited homes (Vilnay 1968: 321). Mazar (1954) published a burial cave, above which was a carved inscription in Hebrew indicating the 'Tomb of Menashe son of Yannai'. His description follows:

"In the photograph of the burial cave we see that a one-line inscription is engraved high up on the back wall of the cave's courtyard which is now concealed, which would have been clearly visible to those descending from the courtyard entrance onto its floor. The courtyard's three walls, hewn in soft rock, were chiseled and smoothed, and apparently each of them bore an entrance to the burial chamber. The wall on which the inscription is carved was smoothed from the surface level and down to the roughly hewn protruding arch, which is above the entrance to the burial chamber... from a paleographic aspect the inscription should be ascribed to the Herodian Era, and it is the first Hebrew inscription from this period of time that has been discovered in northern Israel... from an administrative aspect, these settlements apparently belonged to the Nabatah province, most of whose inhabitants

were Jews already in the Hasmonaean and Herodian Periods". During our visit in 1982 we were unable to locate the cave and the inscription.

The cemetery of the ancient settlement is located on the northern slope of the spur on which the village is built. Its inception is apparently in the Iron Age, and it was in use up to the Byzantine period. An Iron Age II burial cave was excavated here (Magen and Eisenstadt 2004: 63–72), which includes two rooms (4.85×4.3 m) cut into hard limestone rock. The entrance is through a shaft (0.7×0.5 m) leading into a front room, the floor of which is levelled rock. In the room's northern wall, an elongated cell (1.7 m wide and 0.8 m deep) was cut, probably used for laying the deceased. From an opening in the eastern wall there was a passage into a smaller room (2×1.5×1.3 m). The tomb has been dated to the 10th–8th centuries BCE, and was apparently used by an extended family.

Pottery: Iron II – 30%; Hellenistic – 10%; Early Roman – 10%; Late Roman – 20%; Byzantine – 15%; Early Moslem – 5%; Middle Ages – 5%; Ottoman – 5%.

Previous surveys: None.



212. Inscription above burial cave reading, "Tomb of Menashe son of Yannai" at 'Illar (Mazar 1954: 155).

Site 179: 16-19/47/1

Kafr Ra'y (on British Survey map: Ra'ay)

Israel grid: 1649 1978	Soil type: rendzina and terra rossa
UTM grid: 7028 5841	Soil quality: 6
Elevation: 395 m a.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.	Cultivation: none
Name type: on map, but not as ancient site	Cisterns: 19
Site type: Arab village	Water source: Bir Safa (no. 46), 2.5 km distant
Area: 12 dunams (1.2 ha) (ancient core)	Road: 'Illar-Ra'y (C3), at site
Topography: edge of ridge	Visibility: 5
Rock type: Mount Scopus group	Date of visit: Apr. 1982; 50 sherds

A very large Arab village on a ridge oriented generally north-south, on the watershed line of Faḥmeh-Ra'y, between Wadi Massin (to the south) and Wadi Jiz (to the north). From the site is a fine view of the er-Rammeh Valley and the high hill country.

The village now extends over six hilltops, and the ancient core is situated on the southern edge of the ridge. It is limited in circumference, and contains a mosque and several fortified structures, apparently originating in the Middle Ages. During that period there was some sort of fortified complex here, which can still be traced. The rest of the ruin has been obliterated by modern construction. Masonry is visible in places, with ancient cisterns, caves, and quarried places.

This was one of the estates awarded to the loyal men of Sultan Baibars following the conquest of the Crusader kingdom (Abel 1939: 42). In the 1596 Ottoman census, the village belonged to the Qaqun province, and had 35 Moslem taxpayers paying 7914 *aqia* for tax, with main taxation on summer crops (500 *aqia*), olive trees (2000), and goats and honeybees (300) (Hütteroth and 'Abdulfattah 1977: 137).

During the Mamluk period an express road from Jenin to Qaqun passed through the village, along which the mail was carried to Cairo and Damascus (Volney 1798-1799: 280).

The British Survey found here: "A large village on high ground, with good olives to the south, and two wells" (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 154). Grossman (1986: 350) notes here: "part of el-Bireh" (?).

Pottery: Byzantine – 20%; Early Moslem – 10%; Middle Ages – 30%;

Ottoman – 20%; Modern – 20%.

Identification: Alt (1931: 32-33) and Horowitz (1923: 149) proposed identifying the place as 'Beth-eked of the shepherds' (II Kgs 10:12-14). This identification is improbable from the geographical and ceramic aspects: see Chapter 2.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional Bibliography: Kan'el 1954; Abel 1967b: 271; Vilnay 1968: 213.



Site 180: 16-19/57/1

Dhahret es-Safi

Israel grid: 1655 1975

UTM grid: 7034 5839

Elevation: 415 m a.s.l., 40 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: large ruin

Area: 10 dunams (1 ha)

Topography: hilltop and edge of ridge

Rock type: Mount Scopus group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 7

Cultivation: groves

Cisterns: 3

Water source: Bir Safa (no. 46),
2 km distant

Road: 'Illar–Ra'y (C3), 1 km distant

Visibility: 4

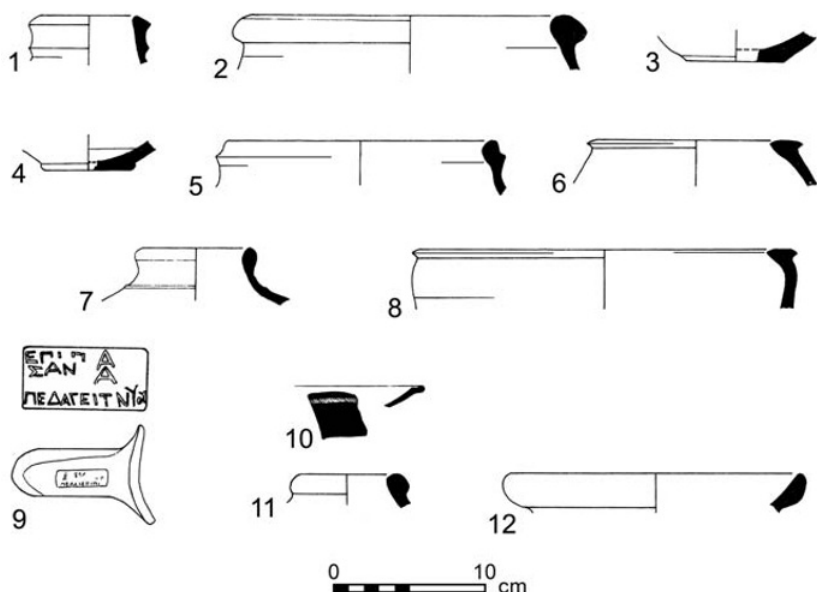
Date of visit: Feb. 1979; 84 sherds

A large site on a flat hilltop, at the edge of a ridge descending from the range that connects Kafr Ra'y and Faḥmeh to the south in the direction of the er-Rammeh Valley. It is situated about 500 m east-south-east of the centre of Kafr Ra'y, and near the unpaved road from er-Rammeh to Ra'y.

In the eastern part are large piles of rocks and mounds of stones, composed of cleared stones from ancient buildings. In the mounds are drafted building stones and many walls *in situ*, which do not join together to form structures. Rock-cut cisterns and two winepresses were found. On the western part is an abandoned Ottoman structure, which previously served as a sheikh's tomb. This is a typical ruin, whose masonry has been extracted for cultivation. A large sherd scatter was found.

Pottery: Iron II – 30%; Persian – 25%; Hellenistic – 25%; Early Roman – 5%; Late Roman – 5%; Byzantine – 10%.

Previous surveys: Zertal 1984: no. 71.



213. Pottery from Dhahret es-Safi: 1.Jar, brn, IA II; 2.Krater, dk, IA II; 3.Jar base, yel, IA-Pers; 4.Jug base, lt, Pers; 5.CP, brn, IA II; 6.Bowl, dk, IA II-III; 7.Jar, yel, Pers; 8.Bowl, yel, IA II-III; 9.Jar handle with seal, import from Rhodes, lt, Hel; 10.'Fish' bowl, blk on yel, Hel; 11.Jug, yel, Pers; 12.Bowl, yel, Pers.



Site 181: 16-19/17/1

Khirbet Massin

Israel grid: 1612 1959

UTM grid: 6992 5821

Elevation: 314 m a.s.l., 100 m a.s.a.

Name type: on map as historic site

Site type: large town

Area: about 60 dunams (6 ha)

Topography: high summit on mountainous height

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: rendzina and brown forest

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: groves

Cisterns: about 40

Water source: Bir es-Siflani (no. 43), 3.7 km distant

Road: Yemmeh-Zawiyah (C2), 3 km distant

Visibility: 5

Date of visit: March 1979; 94 sherds



214. Khirbet Massin, looking south-east. It is situated on the light-coloured summit. Photo: M. Einav, 1997.

A very large site on the eastern summit of Jebel Massin, a high, steep mountainous block located about 1.5 km south-east of the village of 'Illar. The site's very steep slopes descend southward to deep Wadi Massin and to the other sides. It is approachable with great difficulty from all directions, and only two built paths reach the site from east and north. Presumably these paths were also the ancient approaches.

On the summit, near E.P. 314 (the site's centre), dense construction over an area of about 10 dunams (1 ha) has been preserved. There are building complexes *in situ*, including a series of well-built rooms. Structures are well preserved up to a height of 3–6 courses. Most of the rooms are square, 5×5 m on the average. Between the structures streets and passageways can be discerned, as well as many rock-cut cisterns, caves, and installations.

On all sides of the built-up core are traces of solitary structures that stood outside the central area. In each of these are several rooms, and built paths leading to them and connecting them to each other. These pathways can be easily traced. There are occasional pieces of stone arches, thresholds, and lintels with traces of carving on them.

To the east and west of the site are several particularly large rock-cut cisterns, perhaps public ones, with openings and stairs leading down into them. About 200 m north of the centre on a saddle, a large structure with

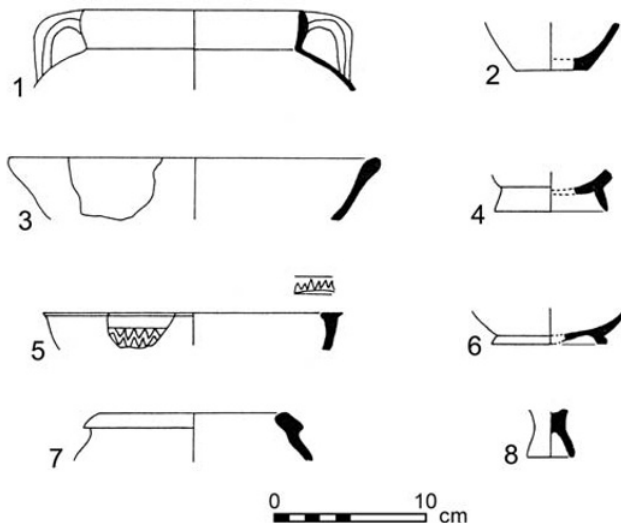
rooms and a courtyard, now abandoned, has been preserved, apparently built in the 19th century.

The British Survey, which visited the site in August 1872, described: "Khurbet Massin - Large and small rooms, as of a monastery, in ruins, of soft white stone, much crumbled with age. The mortar has disappeared. A deep well, now dry; a large vault of masonry, and partly cut in the rock. By it is a large circular clump of terebinths. The walls are standing a few courses high. The place was said to be a Deir, or monastery." (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 198).

This large site is situated in a unique place: it is dominant, is distant from every road, and difficult to approach and attack. The defensive considerations of the location and the distance of the settlement indicate that it may have been a religious complex (church, monastery, or monks' estate during the Byzantine period). The tradition to which the British Survey was exposed also points to such a possibility.

Pottery: Hellenistic – 5%; Roman – 20%; Byzantine – 55%; Early Moslem – 10%; Middle Ages – 10%.

Previous surveys: None.



215. Pottery from Khirbet Massin: 1.CP, brn, LR; 2.Juglet base, dk, Byz; 3.Bowl, lt, ER; 4.Juglet base, pk, ER; 5.Bowl, carved dec on lt, EM; 6.Jar base, gr, LR; 7.Bowl, gr, MA; 8.Unguentarium-like juglet, pk, Hel.

Site 182: 16-19/46/1

El-Khirbeh (Ra'y)

Israel grid: 1641 1969	Soil quality: 5
UTM grid: 7021 5832	Cultivation: orchards
Elevation: 355 m a.s.l., 35 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: 1
Name type: nearest place	Water source: Bir Safa (no. 46),
Site type: medium-sized	3.5 km distant
Area: about 6 dunams (6000 sq. m)	Road: Yemmeh–Zawiyeh (C2),
Topography: hilltop	300 m distant
Rock type: Mount Scopus group	Visibility: 5
Soil type: terra rossa and brown forest	Date of visit: Sept. 1978, Apr. 1985;
	70 sherds

A site on a prominent hilltop in the hilly area about 1 km south-west of Kafr Ra'y. Next to it, to the north, runs a road from 'Illar to Ra'y. The site affords a partial view of the er-Rammeh Valley to the south-east.

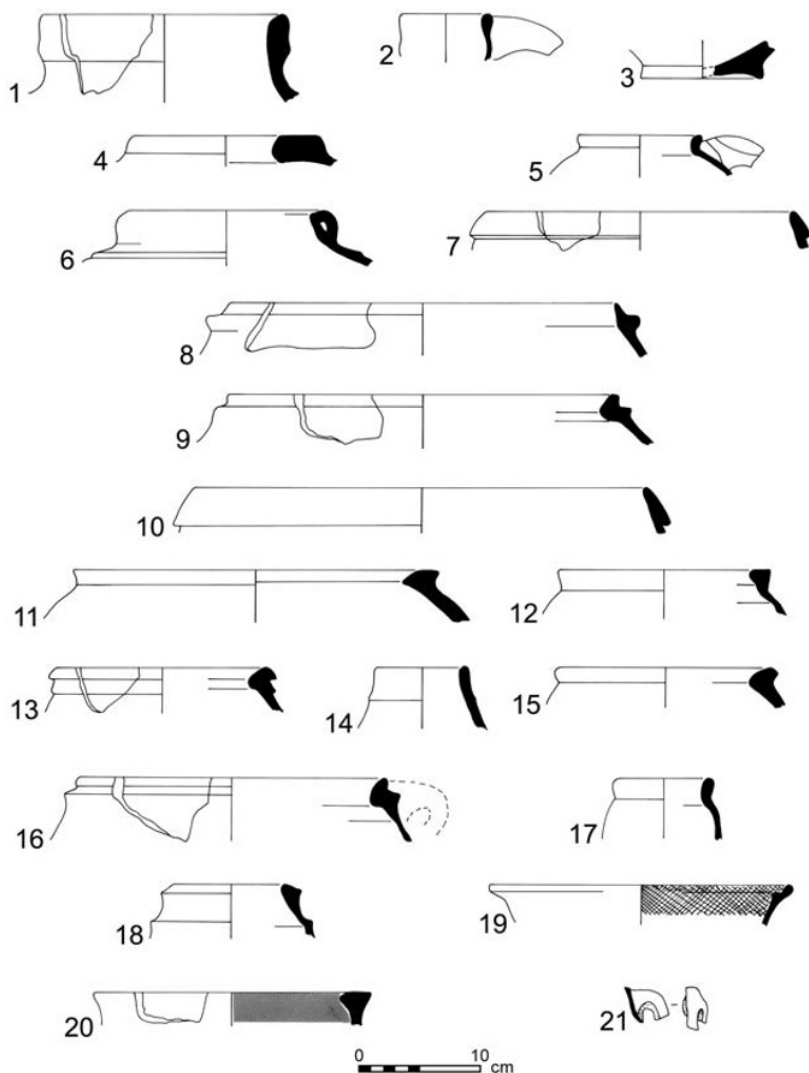
The hill of the site is cultivated and stepped with terraces on all sides. On the summit are traces of courtyards, whose walls incorporate ancient construction. There are also many quarried places – agricultural installations, quarries, and cisterns – as well as a structure which has not been dismantled. There are also many caves, some of which were perhaps used for burial. Similar quarried places were also found on the eastern slope of the site.

On the summit and slopes, primarily the southern slope, are large sherd scatters. There are traces of building over the entire surface, and possibly one of the terraces was a fortification wall.

Pottery: Middle Bronze II – 5%; Iron I – 25%; Iron II – 25%; Persian – 5%; Early Roman – 10%; Late Roman – 5%; Byzantine – 10%; Early Moslem – 5%; Middle Ages – 10%.

Previous surveys: Zertal 1988: no. 195.

Additional Bibliography: Salem 2006: site 175.



216. Pottery from el-Khirbeh (Ra'y): 1, 6. Pithoi, dk gr, IAI; 2. Jug, gr, IA II; 3. Krater base, br, IA I-II; 4. HM, gr, IA II; 5. Jug, yel, IA II; 7. CP type B, dk, IA Ib; 8. CP, brn, IA Ic; 9. CP type D, dk brn, IA II; 10. CP-krater, brn, IA I; 11. Krater, dk brn, IA I; 12. Jar, gr/rd, IA II; 13, 15. Jars, yel, MB II; 14. Jar, lt, Pers; 16. CP, dk, IA II; 17. Jug, lt, Pers; 18. Jar, gr/rd, IA II; 19. Bowl, brn glaze, MA; 20. 'Samaritan' bowl, rd on wh, IA II; 21. Perforated handle, gr, MB I-II.

Site 183: 16-19/55/1

Er-Ras

Israel grid: 1658 1955

UTM grid: 7038 5819

Elevation: 378 m a.s.l., 45 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: sherd scatter

Area: 0.3 dunam (300 sq. m)

Topography: hill, mountainous
height

Rock type: 'Avdat group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 7

Cultivation: olive groves

Cisterns: 1

Water source: Bir Safa (no. 46),
3.5 km distant

Road: Wadi Massin (C18), 1.5 km
distant

Visibility: 4

Date of visit: Jan. 1979; 31 sherds

A small site on a large hill in the form of an echeloned tell, part of the hilly plateau west of the village of er-Rammeh.

No trace of settlement was found on the summit. On the south-west slope of the hill and under its rim, a sherd scatter was found. Apparently the stones of the site were integrated into the fences of cleared stones. The quantity of sherds indicates that one or two houses stood here.

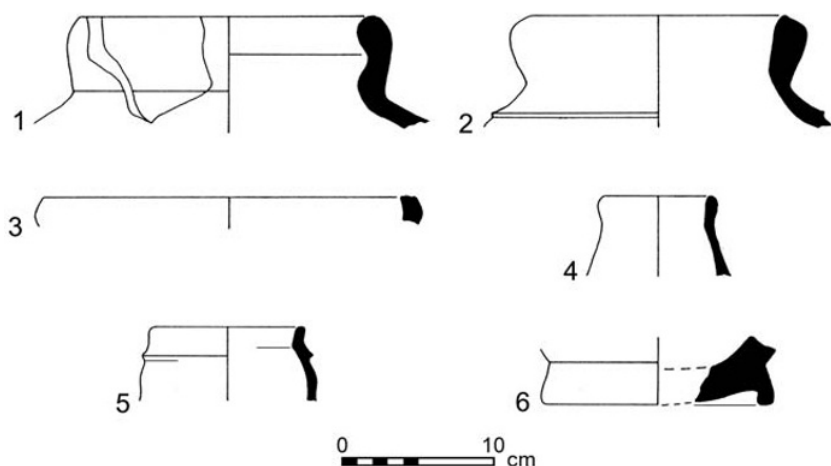
Pottery: Iron I – 100%.

Previous surveys: None.

Bibliography: Salem 2006: site 277.



217. The site of er-Ras, facing east. The site is in an olive orchard on a rocky hilltop. Behind it is the village of er-Rammeh. Photo: A. Zertal, 1979.



218. Pottery from er-Ras, all IA I: 1-2. Pithoi, gr and yel; 3. Krater, brn; 4. Jug, yel; 5. Jug, lt; 6. Krater base, brn.



Site 184: 16-19/56/1

El-Meqoqaz

Israel grid: 1655 1962

UTM grid: 7034 5825

Elevation: 345 m a.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: structure on small ruin

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: hilltop at edge of ridge

Rock type: Mount Scopus group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 8

Cultivation: groves

Cisterns: 3

Water source: Bir Safa (no. 46),
3.2 km distant

Road: Wadi Massin (C18), 2 km
distant

Visibility: 3

Date of visit: Feb. 1979; 19 sherds

A small site at the edge of a long ridge, descending south from the high range of Faḥmeh–Ra'y to Wadi Bab et-Tin and the er-Rammeh Valley, 1.5 km south-south-east of Kafr Ra'y.

A large, abandoned structure was found, which includes wings and a courtyard, and adjacent quarried places and cisterns. On the south-western part of the site's ridge are many remains of walls built of large cut stones and the stone opening of a well with a stone lid. Many structures stood in

this area, some of which have been preserved.

The southern slopes are terraced and cultivated. Many building stones are integrated into the terraces and on the steps.

Pottery: Byzantine – 100%.

Previous surveys: None.



Site 185: 16-19/35/1

Wadi Bab et-Tin

Israel grid: 1634 1953

UTM grid: 7013 5815

Elevation: 270 m a.s.l., 160 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: structure

Area: 0.4 dunam (400 sq. m)

Topography: ridge

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: brown forest

Soil quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 1

Water source: Bir Safa (no. 46),
4.8 km distant

Road: Wadi Massin (C18), 500 m
distant

Visibility: 2

Date of visit: Jan. 1979; 28 sherds

A structure on a high, narrow ridge, about 50 m above the junction of Wadi Bab et-Tin and Wadi Massin, at the edge of the ridge between these wadis.

At the site a structure about 5×5 m has been preserved to a height of 3 m. It is situated on a small natural flat area in the middle of the ridge. Its masonry is of large stones, 40×40×100 cm on the average. The structure must have been quite high, since many more such building stones are scattered about. The structure is located next to a path that descends from the back of the ridge to the junction of the wadis, and thus it is possible that it served as a stronghold for observing and guarding this strategic place. About 40 m below it to the west is a well-cut cistern, including a channel and a collection surface.

Pottery: Byzantine – 100%.

Previous surveys: None.

Site 186: 16-19/45/1

Dar el-Muthamna

Israel grid: 1647 1950

UTM grid: 7027 5813

Elevation: 388 m a.s.l., 5 m a.s.a.

Name type: appears on map, but not as historic site

Site type: fort?

Area: 0.7 dunam (700 sq. m)

Topography: hilltop on mountainous height

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 7

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 1

Water source: Bir Safa (no. 46), 4.5 km distant

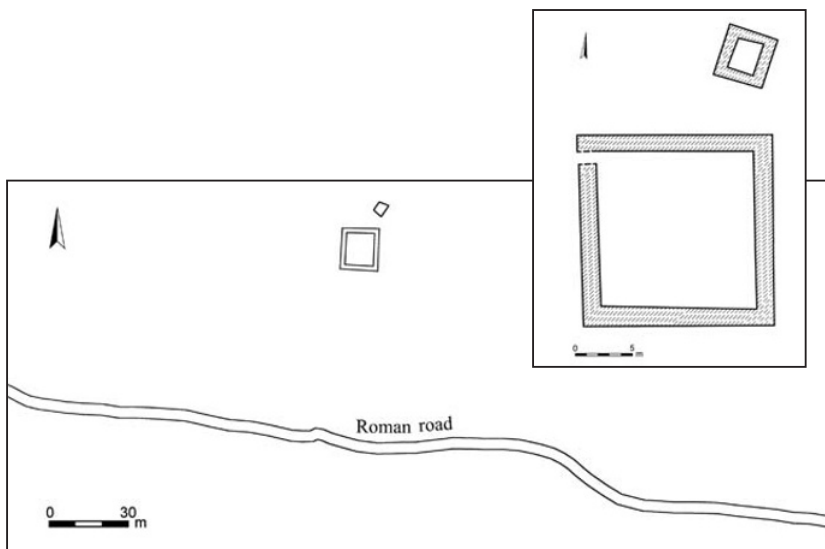
Road: Wadi Massin (C18), 500 m distant

Visibility: 4

Date of visit: Jan. 1979, plan Nov. 1997; 36 sherds

A site in the centre of a very broad ridge between Wadi Massin to the south and Bab et-Tin to the north, about 1.5 km west-south-west of the village of er-Rammeh.

At the site is a large, square structure, about 16×16 m. The surrounding wall is about 1.5 m wide, and partially covered by cleared stones. The original construction of the corners is of good quality, and the masonry



219. Plan of the Dar el-Muthamna site and the Roman road, 1997.

consists of large and medium-sized stones which were carefully cut and placed by the header-and-stretcher method. To the east and north outside the structure, there are walls running parallel to the original thick wall, and between the thin and thick walls is a 1.5 m wide passageway. A 3×3 m square tower was found north of the northern wall.

Surrounding the structure and in its vicinity are concentrations of square buildings ('*mausolea*'). Apparently the fortified structure was connected with them, and may have even served as some kind of centre.

About 60 m south of the structure is a well-built road, stretching east-west along the ridge, and apparently descending to a saddle in the direction of the village of er-Rammeh. Presumably this was a Roman road which was associated with the fort, which must have been built in order to defend the cultivated area.

Pottery: Late Roman – 20%; Byzantine – 80%.

Previous surveys: None.



Site 187: 16-19/64/1

Dar el-Isyar

Israel grid: 1668 1946	Soil quality: 6
UTM grid: 7048 5810	Cultivation: field crops
Elevation: 340 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: 1
Name type: nearest place	Water source: 'Ein Silan (no. 70),
Site type: farm	3.5 km distant
Area: 0.5 dunam (500 sq. m)	Road: Wadi Massin (C18), 1 km
Topography: mountainous height	distant
Rock type: Judah group	Visibility: 6
Soil type: terra rossa	Date of visit: Jan. 1979; 25 sherds

A structure and a courtyard in the eastern part of Dar el-Isyar Range, about 1 km south-east of the village of er-Rammeh.

The site is located at the edge of a rocky ridge that descends southward to the er-Rammeh Valley: of which there is a good view from the site. At the site is a structure about 8×10 m, built of large cut field stones. Although only the bottom course of the stones remains, its plan is easily visible, and

included several units or rooms. A large courtyard, 25×35 m, is attached to the south-eastern corner of the structure. The courtyard is also built of large cut field stones, one row wide. Beneath and to the south of the structure are a rock-cut winepress and a cistern whose opening is blocked.

This is a typical farm of the Roman-Byzantine period.

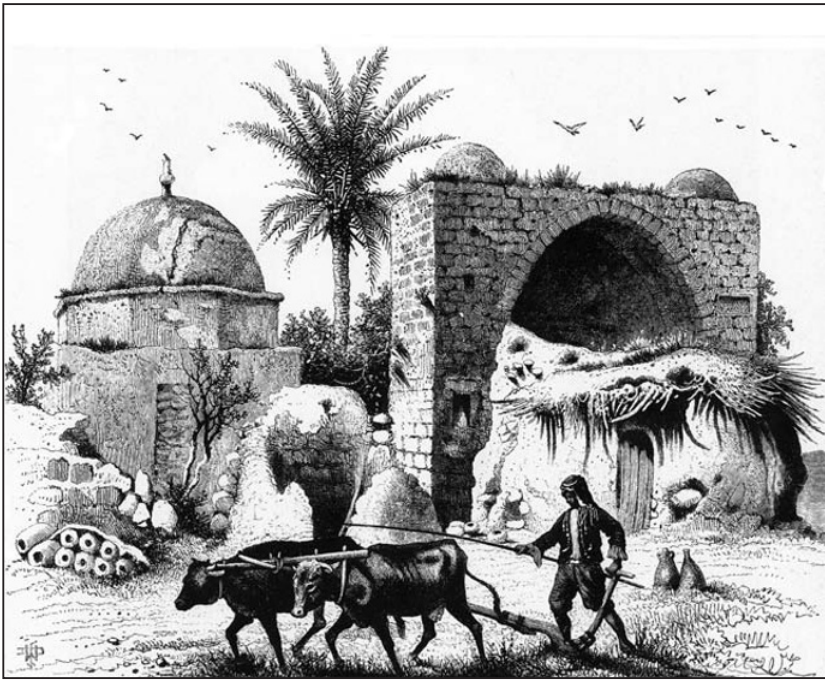
Pottery: Byzantine – 100%.

Previous surveys: None.

CHAPTER SEVEN

THE AREA OF BAL'AH

LANDSCAPE UNIT 26



220. Samarian landscape, etching from Charles Wilson's *Picturesque Palestine* (London, 1880).

Site 188: 15-19/47/1

Qubur ed-Dadaiyat (A)

Israel grid: 1542 1975	Soil quality: 8
UTM grid: 6922 5836	Cultivation: groves
Elevation: 75 m a.s.l., 30 m b.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name type: nearest place	Water source: Bir 'Ibthan (no. 155),
Site type: large	300 m distant
Area: 40 dunams (4 ha)	Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), 1 km
Topography: valley fringes	distant
Rock type: 'Avdat group	Visibility: 2
Soil type: alluvium	Date of visit: Dec. 1987; 49 sherds

A 300 m long strip-site in the south-west of Sahel 'Ibthan, lying along the road from Khirbet Yemmeh to 'Ibthan. Along this road is a 20-40 m wide strip on which is a sherd scatter from Middle Bronze Age II. There are also many building stones, some scattered, and others incorporated in fences made of cleared stones.

Above the strip are cultivation terraces, upon which the ancient site once extended. Due to a thick covering of plants, they could not be explored. The site was dismantled for agricultural activities, and no longer exists.

This seems to have been an unwallled dispersed site that extended along the edges of the cultivated valley. Similar sites have been discovered in the eastern Dothan Valley and on the fringes of the Ṭubas Valley.

Pottery: Middle Bronze IIb – 100%.

Previous surveys: None.

Site 189: 15-19/47/2

Qubur ed-Dadaiyat (B)

Israel grid: 1544 1973	Soil quality: 8
UTM grid: 6923 5833	Cultivation: groves
Elevation: 75 m a.s.l., 30 m b.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name type: nearest place	Water source: Bir 'Ibthan (no. 155),
Site type: large	300 m distant
Area: 10 dunams (1 ha)	Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1),
Topography: valley fringes	1.2 km distant
Rock type: 'Avdat group	Visibility: 2
Soil type: alluvium cover	Date of visit: Dec. 1987; 49 sherds

A large site on the fringes of Sahel 'Ibthan and west of the village of the same name, in the south-eastern part of the site Qubur ed-Dadaiyat (A). North-east of the village of 'Ibthan, at the edge of the road connecting it to the 'Attil–Yemmeh road, traces of a site were found, containing structural remains. These extended over several cultivation terraces at the edge of the valley. On the steps between the terraces, which are now covered with olive groves, are traces of walls made of field stones (some of these are now terrace walls) and a sherd scatter.

Apparently the existence of the nearby earlier site, Qubur ed-Dadaiyat (A), was halted at the end of the Middle Bronze Age II. In its eastern part a more limited site developed, which continued until the Roman period. In time, the village of 'Ibthan 'inherited' it and preserved the ancient name.

Pottery: Middle Bronze IIb – 5%; Iron II – 5%; Persian – 10%; Hellenistic – 70%; Early Roman – 10%.

Previous surveys: None.

Site 190: 15-19/47/3

'Ibthan (on British Survey: Khurbet Ibthan)

Israel grid: 1547 1970	Soil quality: 6
UTM grid: 6927 5831	Cultivation: groves (at site)
Elevation: 80 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: about 20
Name type: appears on map as ancient	Water source: Bir 'Ibthan (no. 155), at site
Site type: Arab village on large site	Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), 1.5 km distant
Area: 25 dunams (2.5 ha)	Visibility: 3
Topography: slope on valley fringe	Date of visit: Jan. 1988; 56 sherds
Rock type: 'Avdat group	
Soil type: terra rossa	

A small Arab village on top of a large ancient site extending along the edges of Sahel 'Ibthan.

In the modern village there is a small core from the Ottoman period (which appears as a *khirbeh* on the British Survey map of 1872), around which a modern settlement has recently developed. In the eastern and northern edges of the village are a considerable number of terraces in which cut building stones are integrated. On and near the slopes are a great many protrusions, beneath which are structures.

The ancient site was much larger than the modern one. It went through several stages of development, as indicated by the various sites surrounding it.

This place appears as an estate granted by Sultan Baibars following the victory over the Crusaders in 1265 (Abel 1939: 41). In this list it appears as Bathan. Its lands were granted to: "The emir 'Alam al-Din Sanjar al-Halabi al-Salihi, all of Bathan" (Lyons 1971: 81). In the 1596 census it appeared as "empty" (*hali*) (Hütteroth and 'Abdulfattah 1977: 127). In the British Survey it was noted that there were "traces of ruins and a well" (Conder and Kitchen 1882: 196).

In 2008 a salvage excavation at the northern slope of the site (Israel grid 1546/1971; Toueg 2010) revealed the remains of a large structure built at the end of the 1st century BCE, and in use until the beginning of the 2nd century CE.

In another salvage excavation conducted in the plain area north-east of the ancient core (Masarwa 2011a-c; 2012), were found several structures (Israel grid 1548/1970) from the Hellenistic and Roman-Byzantine periods,

and a section of a road (Israel grid 1548/1969) from the Early Roman period.

Pottery: Persian – 5%; Hellenistic – 2%; Roman-Byzantine – 88%; Middle Ages – 5%.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional Bibliography: Porath et al. 1985: Site no. 36; Abu Fana 2006.



221. The village of 'Ibthan, facing east. In the background is Sahel 'Ibthan and beyond it are the houses of 'Attil. Photo: M. Weinberg, 1998.

Site 191: 15-19/56/1

Khirbet Abu Sa'

Israel grid: 1551 1967

UTM grid: 6930 5827

Elevation: 100 m a.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.

Name type: appears on map as
ancient

Site type: structure and cemetery

Area: 2 dunams (2000 sq. m)

Topography: slope on valley fringe

Rock type: 'Avdat group

Soil type: rendzina and terra rossa

Soil quality: 4

Cultivation: groves

Cisterns: 1

Water source: Bir 'Ibthan (no. 155),
400 m distant

Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), 2 km
distant

Visibility: 2

Date of visit: Jan. 1988; 29 sherds

A small site on a slope descending into a small ravine that separates 'Ibthan from the ancient site, and to Sahel 'Ibthan, about 500 m east of 'Ibthan.

At the site are two distinct parts:

1. A structure in ruins, 6×11 m, to which a courtyard is attached on the northern side. The structure's wall, 0.8 m thick, is poorly built of small stones which are held in place with lime mortar. The structure's walls now stand to a height of 1 m. Presumably, the structure dates to the 19th century CE.
2. To the north and west of this is a concentration of dozens of openings of plundered rock-cut burial caves. Next to them are many Byzantine sherds. It can be assumed that this was the cemetery of 'Ibthan during the Roman-Byzantine periods.

Pottery: in the structure: Ottoman – 50%; Modern – 50%. In the cemetery: Byzantine – 100%.

Previous surveys: None.

Site 192: 15-19/75/1

Deir el-Ghusun

Israel grid: 1575 1955	Soil quality: 5
UTM grid: 6955 5816	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 230 m a.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: 35
Name type: appears on map as ancient	Water source: Bir 'Ibthan (no. 155), 3 km distant
Site type: Arab village on ruin	Road: Wadi Massin (C18), 500 m distant
Area: 2 dunams (2000 sq. m)	Visibility: 6
Topography: hilltop	Date of visit: Dec. 1982; 33 sherds
Rock type: Judah group	
Soil type: terra rossa	

A large village on the high southern rim of Wadi Massin, in the hilly area covered with olive trees. It is located west of the Bal'ah Range and at the edge of the Sharon Plain.

The contemporary village extends over four hills; the ancient core is found on one of the middle ones. This core contains a mosque and next to it, a well-built ancient structure, which has a courtyard and several old trees. The core is very small and difficult to identify. A painstaking search yielded only a few ancient sherds.

Apparently this site was originally a small Byzantine monastery (*deir*), around which the village was eventually built, possibly in the late Middle Ages. Modern construction has covered the ancient site, making identification difficult. Possibly the settlement itself may have been in nearby Khirbet Hamarrah.

The meaning of the name is 'monastery of the branch'. In 1265 it was one of the estates granted by Sultan Baibars following the victory over the Crusaders (Abel 1939: 41). According to the document, "The emir Bader al-Din Muhammad Bi, son of the emir Husam al-Din Baraka Khan" received "Dair al-Ghusun in its entirety" (Lyons 1971: 81). In the opinion of Grossman (1986: 345) the site was vacated and was resettled in the 17th century, and the archaeological find supports this view.

Robinson (1970, III: 124–125) visited here on 22 Apr. 1852 and describes: "From 'Attil we now turned again up the mountain, following the direct road to Nabulus; and taking a guide for Ramin. Leaving the village at 11:15, we descended into the southern basin, and then entered a long shallow valley running up on the right of Deir el-Ghusun and its hill. A string of ten camels,

led by donkeys, was slowly climbing the hill to that village. At 11:50 we were at the top of the valley; Deir el-Ghusun bearing north 700E, half a mile distant. The region is full of olive trees. A valley comes down from the south nearly to the village, and then sweeps round to the west. This we crossed, and then rose upon sloping ground on our left. At 12.05 we came out upon the brow of the deep Valley Mussin, coming from the plain of Fendekumieh; it is said to unite with Wady Abu Nar in the western plain beyond Jett. We reached the bottom of the valley at 12.20; and noticed its deep water-channel, now dry.—The road thus far from 'Attil was evidently very old; but we saw no appearance of pavement. Whether this was the ancient way from Caesarea to Sebaste may be doubted; since a more feasible route exists from the plain along the great Wady Sha'ir, which comes down from Nabulus, and is the next valley south of Wady Mussin."

Guérin (1969b: 345) relates: "south of Deir 'Attil I saw Deir Ghusun, a village that at a distance appears relatively large, which also sits upon a hilltop" [translated from French, A.Z.].

The British Survey team found: "A village of moderate size, on a hill, with a well (Bir el Akaribeh) to the west. On the north is open low ground. It is surrounded with magnificent groves of olives, occupying an area of about three square miles towards the south." (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 152).

Pottery (in ancient core): Byzantine – 5%; Early Moslem – 5%; Middle Ages – 50%; Ottoman – 40%.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional Bibliography: Vilnay 1968: 125.

Site 193: 15-19/95/1

Khirbet Wasil (on British Survey map: Kh. Wuseil)

Israel grid: 1593 1953	Soil quality: 5
UTM grid: 6973 5814	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 274 m a.s.l., 100 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: 10
Name type: appears on map as historic site	Water source: Bir 'Ibthan (no. 155), 5 km distant
Site type: fort (?)	Road: Wadi Massin (C18), 500 m distant
Area: 2.4 dunams (2400 sq. m)	Visibility: 9
Topography: high summit	Date of visit: Dec. 1981, plan - July 1997; 52 sherds
Rock type: 'Avdat group	
Soil type: rendzina and terra rossa	

A fortified site on a high summit at the edge of an elongated mountain ridge that descends west from Bal'ah in the direction of Deir el-Ghusun. The ridge is situated between the junction of Wadi Massin and Wadi Sultan in the north and Wadi Sialehin in the south.

The summit of the site is protected by steep slopes to the west, north, and south. It is conveniently approached via a saddle to the south-east. It affords a good view of the coastal plain, to the access to Wadi Massin, Sahel 'Ibthan, and the Şeida-Ra'y Hills.

In the centre of the site is a square building, about 20×20 m, fortified with a wall 2–4 m thick built of large field stones. The dense vegetation made it difficult to follow the plan of this central structure, but it clearly contained a courtyard and rooms, and an entrance in the east.

From the central structure the site's buildings extend south-eastwards. Here is an elevated rectangular surface, divided into three parts: to the south, an entrance with a series of rooms next to it, formed by dividing walls; in the centre a rectangle with various structures; and adjacent to the north-eastern corner of the citadel is a rectangular structure. Outside the complex to the north is some sort of square tower.

All the structures, with the exception of the central one, have masonry of Herodian ashlar (drafted margins and boss). A sherd scatter was found both on the area of the structures and on the slopes. The British Survey found: "Walls and foundations, apparently not very ancient" (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 198).

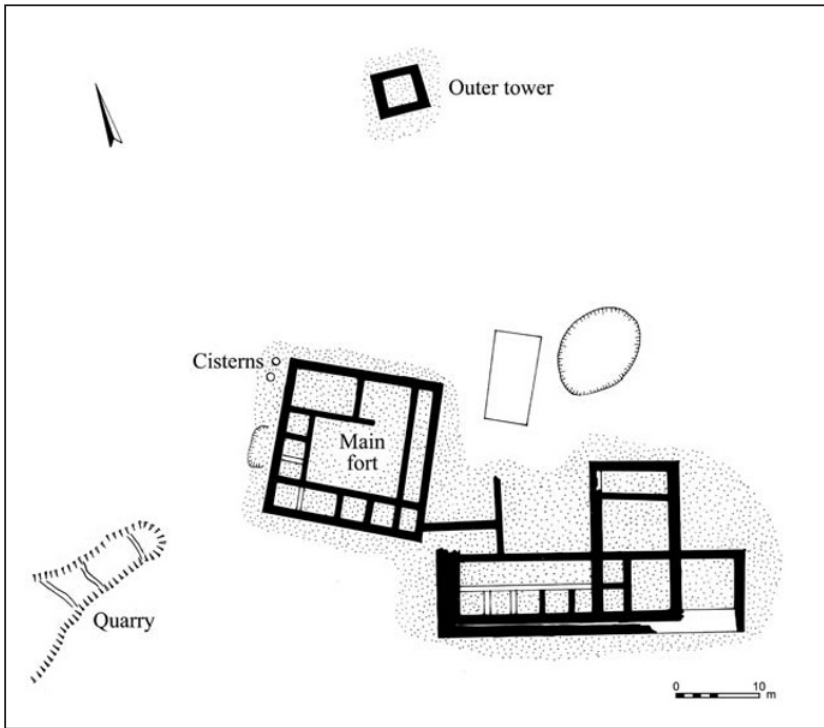
The site appears to be a 'citadel' from the Late Roman period, which guarded the access to Wadi Massin. Through this wadi was a path that

led directly to the er-Rammeh Valley and to Sebastiyeh. The 'citadel' was built on an earlier site from the Middle Bronze Age, Iron Age, Hellenistic, and Early Roman periods. It resembles the plan of Kh. el-Qebubeh (Zertal 2004: site 181).

Pottery: Middle Bronze IIB – 20%; Iron I – 5%; Hellenistic – 20%; Early Roman – 25%; Late Roman – 30%.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional Bibliography: Dauphin 1998, III: site 176.



222. Plan of Khirbet Wasil, 1997. Note the complex structure, whose function is unclear, to the right of the citadel.

Site 194: 15-19/34/1

Es-Suweisseh

Israel grid: 1538 1948	Cultivation: olive grove
UTM grid: 6918 5809	Cisterns: none
Elevation: 90 m a.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.	Water source: 'Ein Jeruhiyeh (no. 156), 1 km distant
Name type: nearest place	Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), 1 km distant
Site type: medium-sized	Visibility: 2
Area: about 8 dunams (8000 sq. m)	Date of visit: Mar. 1998; sherds, flint and basalt artifacts
Topography: slope	(see Appendix A)
Rock type: 'Avdat group	
Soil type: terra rossa	
Soil quality: 7	

A site on a southern slope descending to Wadi esh-Sham, in the hilly area of Yemmeh–Marjeh, and about 1.2 km north of the village of Shuweikeh.

The site extends over a saddle on a moderate slope where olive groves have been planted. On the surface are considerable quantities of flint, basalt, and other stone artifacts and sherds, with no architectural remains. There are also a great many pestles, basalt hammer-heads, etc. Many flint adzes and other tools were found.

The site was an active settlement during the Neolithic and Chalcolithic periods, that was connected with the water source in Wadi esh-Sham or the spring of 'Ein Jeruhiyeh. The rocks at the site bear numerous cup-marks and signs of quarrying.

Pottery, flint and basalt: Pre-Pottery Neolithic B – 50%; Chalcolithic – 50%.

Previous surveys: None.

See Appendix A.

Site 195: 15-19/84/1

Khirbet Bajjurah

Israel grid: 1582 1941	Soil quality: 6
UTM grid: 6962 5802	Cultivation: olive grove
Elevation: 205 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: 4
Name type: appears as ancient on map	Water source: Nahal Shechem (no. 102), 2.5 km distant
Site type: medium-sized	Road: Shuweikeh–Sila (C5), 800 m distant
Area: 8.8 dunams (8800 sq. m)	Visibility: 2
Topography: slope at edge of hilltop	Date of visit: Dec. 1982; 60 sherds
Rock type: Judah group	
Soil type: terra rossa	

A ruin in the low hills between the villages of Bal'ah and Deir el-Ghuṣun. It is close to the ancient road (Wadi esh-Sham), now an asphalt road, that connects the western part of Nahal Shechem with the northern Sharon Plain. The site is located on the north-eastern edges of an elongated hill (E.P. 208), whose slopes descend northward, in several built terraces, to Wadi esh-Sham.

On the upper eastern part of the hilltop is a large structure of good masonry, most of it *in situ*, part of which collapsed recently. A courtyard, about 6×15 m, is attached to the structure. In its centre is an upper crushing stone for olives, half-buried in the ground. Toward the bottom of the slope and on the built steps are many more ruined structures, and building stones are scattered on the slope. Most of the building stones are cut and smoothed, and some also have chiselled margins. Quite a few large structures can be discerned, also with 1.5–2 m-thick walls.

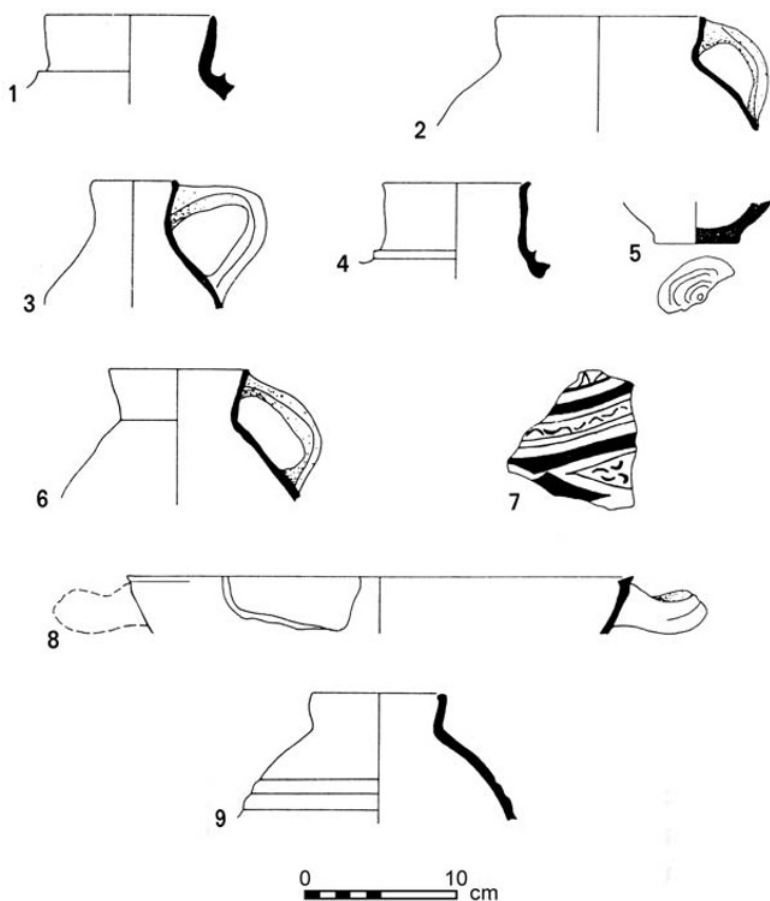
On the western part of E.P. 208, with no clear connection to the site, Iron Age II and Persian sherds were found. It is unclear whether they originated at this site or somewhere else.

The site does not appear in the British Survey. In the Emergency Survey it is defined as “a cleared ruin upon a range. Its area is about 1.5 dunams” (Gophna and Porath 1972: no. 68).

Pottery: Roman – 20%; Byzantine – 45%; Early Moslem – 30%; Middle Ages – 5%.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972: no. 68.

Additional Bibliography: Dauphin 1998, III: site 179.



223. Pottery from Khirbet Bajjurah: 1.Jar, pk, LR; 2.CP, dk, LR; 3, 6.Jug and jar, dk, Byz; 4.Jar, dk, Byz; 5.Jug base, pk, ER; 7.Dec on jug, brn on wh, Mam (MA); 8.'Frying pan', brn, Byz; 9.Jug, dk, Rom.

Site 196: 16-19/04/1

Er-Requq

Israel grid: 1606 1945	Soil quality: 3
UTM grid: 6986 5807	Cultivation: groves
Elevation: 375 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name type: nearest place	Water source: Nahal Shechem (no. 102), 3 km distant
Site type: cemetery	Road: Shuweikeh–Sila (C5), 1 km distant
Area: 10 dunams (1 ha)	Visibility: 6
Topography: mountainous height	Date of visit: Oct. 1981; 64 sherds
Rock type: Judah group	
Soil type: terra rossa	

A cemetery (and traces of a possible site next to it) on a flat summit, about 1 km north of Bal'ah. To the east of the site is a deep ravine containing new houses of this village.

About 50 or more openings of rock-cut graves were found on the surface of the flat hilltop, in the ravine, and among the olive trees. A considerable number are shaft-burials whose openings are round or square, while others (in the ravine) had a convex shape, and some contained a cut façade.

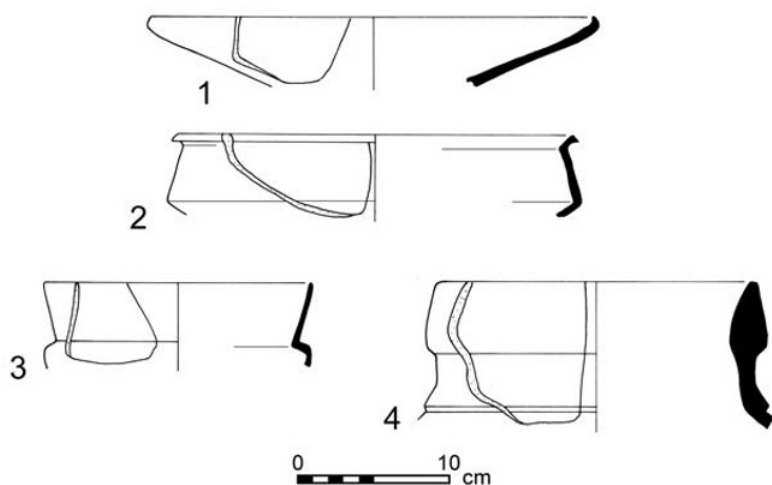
Almost all the caves were found to have been previously plundered, or were in the process of being plundered. Next to them were piles of earth, traces of bones, and many sherds. Some of the graves were in secondary use as agricultural installations and cisterns.

Apparently this central cemetery was larger than could be discerned. In the ravine area, possible remains of a site were found: traces of walls and quarried places. The state of the site did not enable us to determine whether it was a dwelling site or structures associated with the burial.

This site served as a burial place in the region, yet no large Bronze or Iron Age sites have been discovered here. It is possible that this was a cemetery unconnected to a settlement, of the type found in Wadi Far'ah (Zertal 2008a: sites 161–163, 175, 178) or Khirbet Rabud (Kochavi 1972: site 215).

Pottery: Middle Bronze IIb – 25%; Late Bronze II – 25%; Iron I – 25%; Iron II – 25%.

Previous surveys: None.



224. Pottery from er-Requq: 1.Bowl, yel, MB IIb; 2.CP type A, dk, LB I; 3.Carinated bowl, pinkish, LB; 4.Pithos, dk, IA I.



Site 197: 16-19/24/1

Umm et-Tut

Israel grid: 1629 1942

UTM grid: 7010 5804

Elevation: 336 m a.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient, but not on map

Site type: farm

Area: 3 dunams (3000 sq. m)

Topography: hilltop on
mountainous height

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 7

Cultivation: groves

Cisterns: 2

Water source: Nahal Shechem
(no. 102), 4 km distant

Road: Wadi Massin (C18), 500 m
distant

Visibility: 5

Date of visit: Apr. 1981; 52 sherds

A small site in the middle of a ridge descending northward from the high range of Bal'ah toward Wadi Massin. East of it is the ravine of Khallet et-Thurmus, and to the west is the ravine of el-Wad. From here is a limited view of the Ra'y-Fahmeh range.

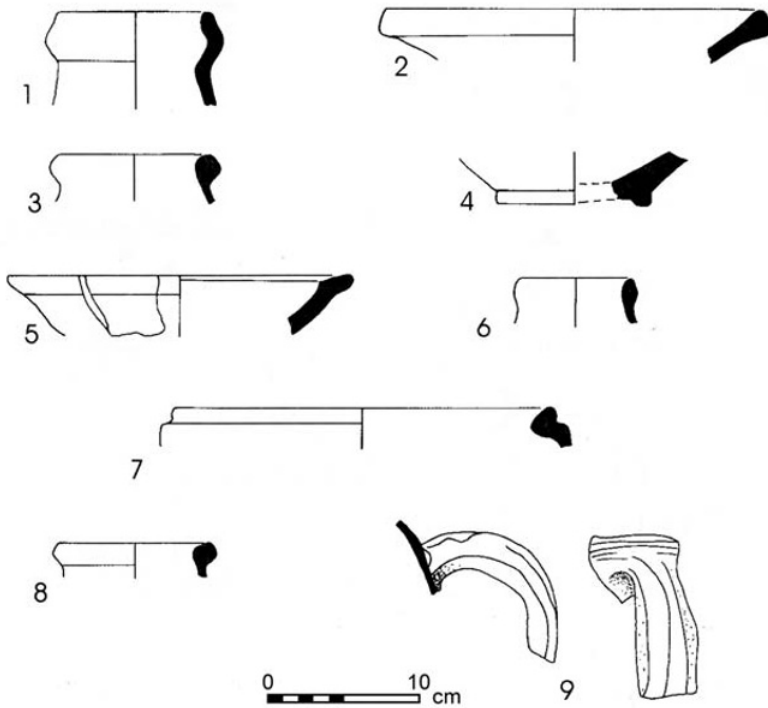
The site is located on a small raised place, and contains a central

structure, upon which were placed cleared stones from other structures of the site, now completely destroyed. The heap of cleared stones on the central structure is about 2 m high and 10 m in diameter. Next to it are traces of square buildings made of cut stones, some of which had been robbed. On the eastern side of the site is a well-cut cistern. A stone wall, whose dating is unclear, borders the site on the northern side. A homogeneous sherd scatter was found all over the site.

This small site is one of the few sites in the sparsely settled area between Bal'ah and the Faḥmeh–Ra'y range.

Pottery: Iron– 4%; Persian – 92%; Byzantine– 4%.

Previous surveys: None.



225. Pottery from Umm et-Tut: 1.Jar, lt, Pers; 2, 5.Bowls, Pers; 3, 4, 6, 8.Jars and jar base, gr and yel, Pers; 7.CP, brn, IA II; 9.Jar handle, brn, Byz.

Site 198: 15-20/34/1

Khirbet Shuweiket er-Ras (in British Survey: Shuweikeh)

Israel grid: 1534 1943	Soil quality: 8
UTM grid: 6914 5803	Cultivation: olive groves
Elevation: 129 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: 6
Name type: ancient	Water source: 'Ein Jeruhiyeh
Site type: tell	(no. 156), 1.3 km distant
Area: 40 dunams (4 ha)	Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), near site
Topography: fringe of Sharon Valley	Visibility: 4
Rock type: Judah group	Date of visit: 1980; 70 sherds
Soil type: terra rossa and alluvium	

A large tell on the eastern fringes of the Sharon Valley, about 3 km north of the town of Tulkarm, and just north of the village of Shuweikeh.

The tell is surrounded by a strip of high terraces, which conceal within them the city wall and its ramparts. The upper area of the site, entirely cultivated now and covered with ancient olive trees, is divided into courtyards by stone walls, most of which stand on ancient walls. On the eastern part is an elevated area, about 10 dunams (1 ha) in area, which seems to have been the city's acropolis. On the surface of the tell are many building stones, cistern openings, and many sherds.

The Emergency Survey recorded this site only as "a tell on the edge of the Sharon drainage area. The tell's area is about 25 dunams" (Gophna and Porath 1972: site 67). Miller (2000: site 1) who surveyed here in 1996, notes a two-roomed Ottoman structure surviving at the south-western corner of the tell, with Umayyad and modern sherds.

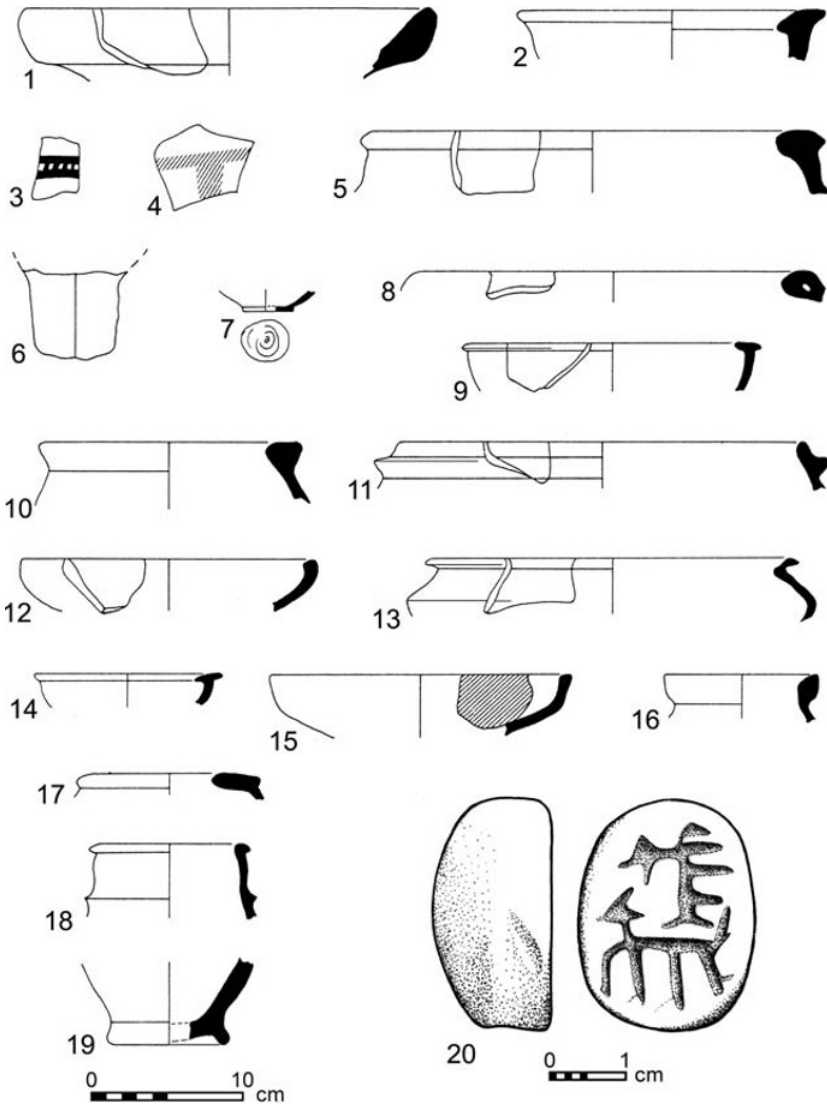
Pottery (in our survey): Middle Bronze IIb – 13%; Late Bronze I-II – 15%; Iron I – 15%; Iron II – 10%; Persian – 10%; Hellenistic – 5%; Early Roman – 5%; Late Roman – 7%; Byzantine – 10%; Early Moslem – 5%.

Special find: scarab seal made of black stone with animal images.

Identification: The tell is identified as *Su4-ku* of the Egyptian sources and Socho of the Third Solomonic District (I Kgs, 4:10); see Chapter 2.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972: no. 67.

Additional Bibliography: Kallai 1982: 284; Dauphin 1998, III: site 178; Goren et al. 2004: 346.



226. Finds from Khirbet Shuweiket er-Ras: 1. Bowl, yel, Pers; 2. Jar, pinkish, MB II; 3. 'Milk bowl', brn on cream, import, LB; 4. Rd dec on jug, LB; 5. Krater, lt, MB II; 6. Jar handle, MB II; 7. Jug base, pk, ER; 8. CP, dk, MB II; 9. Bowl, IA I-II; 10. Jar, lt, MB II-LB; 11. CP, dk, IA I-II; 12. 'Manasseh' bowl, brn, IA I; 13. CP, brn, LB-IA I; 14. Small bowl, lt, IA II-III; 15. Bowl, rd slip, IA II; 16. Jar, yel, Pers-Hel; 17. HM, brn, IA II-III; 18. Jar, reddish, ER; 19. Jug base, brn, IA I-II; 20. Scarab seal, blk stone with horned animal images, LB-IA I (19 mm).

Site 199: 15-19/73/1

El-Khirbeh

Israel grid: 1578 1934

UTM grid: 6958 5795

Elevation: 190 m a.s.l., 35 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient, but not on map

Site type: medium-sized village

Area: 4 dunams (4000 sq. m)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: olive grove

Cisterns: 10

Water source: Nahal Shechem

(no. 102), 2 km distant

Road: Shuweikeh–Sila (C5), at site

Visibility: 2

Date of visit: Nov. 1987; 40 sherds

A medium-sized site on a moderate slope that descends to Wadi Shamaly, in the hilly area north of Nahal Shechem. It is situated about 800 m south of Khirbet Bajjurah, and about 1.7 km north-west of el-Munṭar. The path from Deir el-Ghuṣun to Nahal Shechem passes by the site and continues through Wadi esh-Sham.

On a moderate northern slope within an olive grove, many remains of a settlement were found. The terraces on the slope formed a basis for the buildings, of which many foundations were found *in situ*. Upon the 'steps', which were up to 10 m wide, are clear traces of structures of field stones, which were built one above the other in accordance with the height of the steps. In most cases only the bottom layer remains. Due to the vegetative cover, it was difficult to discern an overall plan for the site, but among the structures at least ten cistern openings were found, belonging to the original site. Some of them are now in secondary use. A built path that descends from the range leads to the settlement.

In and around the site a considerable sherd scatter was found, including typical Iron Age II types.

Pottery: Iron II – 100%;

Previous surveys: None.

Site 200: 16-19/03/1

Bal'ah (in British Survey: Bel'ah)

Israel grid: 1604 1933	Soil type: terra rossa
UTM grid: 6985 5795	Soil quality: 4
Elevation: 380 m a.s.l., 100 m a.s.a.	Cultivation: none
Name type: appears on map, but not as ancient	Cisterns: 28
Site type: Arab village on ruin	Water source: Nahal Shechem (no. 102), 2.2 km distant
Area: 5 dunams (5000 sq. m) (ancient core)	Road: Shuweikeh–Sila (C5), at site
Topography: ridge and slope	Visibility: 2
Rock type: 'Avdat group	Date of visit: Dec. 1982; 46 sherds

A medium-sized village at the low edge of a short broad ridge projecting from the central range of the high hills to the north of Nahal Shechem, about 8 km east-north-east of Tulkarm. At the edge of the ridge, above Wadi Bal'ah, which begins here and leads westward to the coastal plain, is the ancient core of the village.

This core contains a mosque and several houses that were apparently built during the Ottoman period. A meticulous investigation and the collection of sherds on the slopes and in the village led to the conclusion that the site was apparently founded in the 16th–17th centuries CE. The discovery of a grave and an inscription, found by the British Survey team, might possibly be explained by the numerous burials in the area (see the cemetery at er-Requq, Site 196), but this does not explain the origin of the people who were buried here.

The village is not mentioned in the Medieval sources. In the 1596 census there were six Moslems taxpaying who paid a total of 1652 *aqia* for tax, including 710 *aqia* for wheat, 250 for barley, 200 for summer crops, 100 for olive trees, 40 for goats and honeybees, 30 for an oil press and 240 for *jizia* (Hütteroth and 'Abdulfattah 1977: 127).

The British Survey recorded: "A good-sized village on very high ground, with magnificent groves of olives to the west and supplied by cisterns. It is apparently an ancient site, having rock-cut tombs. The name suggests its identity with Bileam, a town in the western half of Manasseh (I Chron. vi. 70)" (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 159). The British Survey further notes: "A tomb was broken into near this village about the time of the Survey visit. It consisted of a single chamber with a loculus on each of three walls. The door

was an inscribed slab, with rude ornamentation. The inscription (Greek) was as below: "one God alone". The last letters were supposed by Mr. Tyrwhitt Drake to form a date, which, reckoning by the Alexandrian Era, would be 332 A.D." (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 172).

Guérin does not mention this village. In the 1931 census there were 1539 residents and 344 inhabited houses (Vilnay 1968: 88). In Grossman's opinion (1986: 351), the residents came from various places: some from Barbara (today's Mavki'im, near Ashkelon) and some from Deir el-Ghuṣun and Jatt. This opinion supports our assumption that the village is relatively new.

Pottery: Ottoman – 80%; Modern – 20%.

Previous surveys: None.



227. The Greek inscription of the burial cave near the village of Bal'ah: "one God alone". The presumed date of the inscription is the 4th century CE (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 172).

Site 201: 15-19/92/1

Ras el-Munṭar

Israel grid: 1592 1923	Soil quality: 5
UTM grid: 6972 5784	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 324 m a.s.l., 100 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name type: appears on map, but not as historic site	Water source: Nahal Shechem (no. 102), 1 km distant
Site type: citadel (?)	Road: Tulkarm–Shechem (B1), 1 km distant
Area: 1.4 dunams (1400 sq. m)	Visibility: 9
Topography: high summit	Date of visit: Nov. 1981; 40 sherds
Rock type: Judah group	
Soil type: terra rossa	

A small fortified site, on a high summit between the Bal'ah Range and Nahal Shechem, and west of the road ascending to Bal'ah. To its north is the narrow road in Wadi esh-Sham from Bal'ah to Deir el-Ghuṣun. From the site is a fine view of the ranges south of Nahal Shechem and of the coastal plain.

The flat summit, 1.4 dunams (1400 sq. m) in area, is surrounded by a wall 1–2 m wide made of small stones, built upon an older foundation of large stones. The entrance was apparently in the north, but it was not definitely found.

In the area surrounded by the wall no structural remains were found, but these may have been dismantled and their stones integrated in the walls of cleared stones. Over the summit and on the slopes of the hill is a medium density sherd scatter.

It is hard to define the essence of the site clearly, since no trace of building exists. The high protected location and the presence of the wall indicate a possible fort. This site can be associated by inference with the network of forts constructed to defend Samaria during the Iron Age (Zertal 2004: 56).

Pottery: Middle Bronze IIb – 5%; Iron III – 95%.

Previous surveys: None.

Site 202: 15-19/83/1

Wadi Ḥamdan

Israel grid: 1580 1931

UTM grid: 6960 5792

Elevation: 200 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: stones mound and sherd scatter

Area: 0.5 dunam (500 sq. m)

Topography: mountainous height

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 5

Cultivation: groves

Cisterns: none

Water source: Nahal Shechem
(no. 102), 1.6 km distant

Road: Tulkarm–Shechem (B1),
1.6 km distant

Visibility: 2

Date of visit: Nov. 1981; 17 sherds

A very small site on a saddle on Bal'ah Heights, about 2 km west of the village.

It is situated just south of the road in Wadi esh-Sham from Bal'ah to Deir el-Ghuṣun. A junction of built paths is located there, as well as a large abandoned Arab house. Close to the house is a small mound of stones, 4 m in diameter and about 1 m high. Around it and the abandoned structure is a sparse sherd scatter.

Pottery: Iron I – 100%.

Previous surveys: Zertal 1988: no. 235.

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Abbreviations

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ABD = Friedman, D.N., (ed.), 1992. *Anchor Bible Dictionary*, vols. 1-6, New York.

ABS = *Anchor Bible Series*.

ANET = Pritchard, J. B., (ed.), 1969. *Ancient Near Eastern Texts Related to the Old Testament* (3rd edition), Princeton.

Ant. = *Josephus, Jewish Antiquities*, with an English Translation by Thackeray, H.St.J., and Marcus, R., (*Loeb Classical Library*), London 1966-1969.

BAR = *Biblical Archaeology Review*.

BAR Int. Ser. = *British Archaeological Reports International Series*.

BASOR = *Bulletin of the American Schools of Oriental Research*.

BCH Supp. = *Bulletin de correspondance hellenique. Supplements*.

CDEI = Mazar, B., 1976. *Cities and Districts in Eretz Israel*, Jerusalem, (Hebrew).

CHANE = *Culture and History of the Ancient Near East* (Series).

CI = Mazar, B., 1980. *Canaan and Israel, Historical Essays*, Jerusalem, (Hebrew).

EB = *Encyclopaedia Biblica*, vols. I-VIII, Jerusalem 1950-1982 (Hebrew).

EI = *Eretz Israel*.

ESI = *Excavations and Surveys in Israel*.

ETA = Zertal, A., (ed.), 2003. *The Excavations at Tell Assawir, A Preliminary Report on the First Two Seasons, 2001-2002*, Haifa (Hebrew).

GM = *Gottinger Miszellen*.

HA = *Hadashot Arkheologiyot* (Hebrew).

HAR = *Hebrew Annual Review*.

HCSA = Bar, S. (ed.), 2008. *In the Hill-Country, and in the Shephelah, and in the Arabah* (Joshua 12, 8), *Studies and Researches Presented to Adam Zertal in the Thirtieth Anniversary of the Manasseh Hill-Country Survey*, Jerusalem.

IAA = *Israel Antiquities Authority*.

IEJ = *Israel Exploration Journal*.

IJES = *Israel Journal of Earth Sciences*.

JAOS = *Journal of the American Oriental Society*.

JEA = *Journal of Egyptian Archaeology*.

JES = *Journal of Earth Sciences*.

JFA = *Journal of Field Archaeology*.

JIPS = *Journal of the Israel Prehistoric Society*.

JJS = *Journal of Jewish Studies*.

JPOS = *Journal of the Palestine Oriental Society*.

JQR = *Jewish Quarterly Review*.

JRA = *Journal of Roman Archaeology*.

JS = Shmueli, A., Grossman, D., and Zeévy, R., (eds.), 1977. *Judah and Samaria, Studies in Settlement Geography*, vols. I-II (*The Land of Israel and the Middle East, Studies in Regional Geography* 1), Jerusalem (Hebrew).

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JSP = *Judea and Samaria Publications*.

JSRs = *Judea and Samaria Research Studies*.

JSS = *Journal of Semitic Studies*.

KS = Alt, A., 1953. *Kleine Schriften zur Geschichte des Volkes Israel* I-II, Muenchen.

MDAIK = *Mitteilungen des Deutschen Archäologischen Instituts, Abt. Kairo*.

MGWJ = *Monatsschrift für Geschichte und Wissenschaft des Judentums*.

NEAEHL = Stern, E., (ed.), 1993-2008. *New Encyclopaedia of Archaeological Excavations in the Holy Land*, vols. 1-5, Jerusalem and Washington.

PEQ = *Palestine Exploration Quarterly*.

PEFQst = *Palestine Exploration Fund Quarterly Statement*.

PJB = *Palaestina Jahrbuch des Deutschen Evangelischen Institut Für Altertumswissenschaft des Heiligen Landes zu Jerusalem*.

RB = *Revue Biblique*.

SB = Ehrlich, Z., (ed.), 1987-1993. *Samaria and Benjamin, Studies in Geographical History*, vols. I-III, Jerusalem (Hebrew).

SBLDS = *Society of Biblical Literature Dissertation Series*.

SS = Dar, S., and Safrai, Z., (eds.), 1986. *Shomron Studies*, Tel Aviv (Hebrew).

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